

Concept Note

Results and Performance of the World Bank Group 2025

August 28, 2025

1. Introduction

1.1 The *Results and Performance of the World Bank Group 2025 (RAP 2025)* report presents a two-part review of the lending and nonlending support of the World Bank Group. Part 1 will focus on trends in project- and country-level effectiveness and will be anchored in the Bank Group's Outcomes horizontal. Part 2 will present an analysis of the use of World Bank advisory services and analytics (ASA) and International Finance Corporation (IFC) advisory services (AS) and will be anchored in the Bank Group's Knowledge and Learning horizontal (see appendix A for definitions of the World Bank ASA and IFC AS). The Board of Executive Directors has expressed strong interest in the effectiveness of the Bank Group's nonlending support, making the *RAP*'s focus on World Bank ASA and IFC AS timely. Unlike IFC AS, the World Bank currently lacks an evaluative framework for ASA. The *RAP*'s focus on ASA use and influence could potentially contribute to future discussions on a Bank Group framework for evaluating ASA and ways to strengthen its outcome focus and renewed aspiration to be a Knowledge Bank.

2. Objectives and Audience

2.1 *RAP 2025* has two objectives: (i) to present trends in Bank Group performance ratings and (ii) to present evidence on the use of World Bank ASA and IFC AS. The analysis in the *RAP* will lay the foundation for future Independent Evaluation Group (IEG) evaluations on Bank Group knowledge engagements.

2.2 The primary audience for *RAP 2025* will be the Bank Group's Board of Executive Directors. The analysis of *RAP 2025* will inform the Board's oversight of the results and performance of the Bank Group's project- and country-level support and also assist Bank Group management and staff regarding the design and implementation of projects and country programs. Based on guidance from the Board of Executive Directors, *RAP 2025* will produce a shorter synthesis highlighting key findings and performance trends for the Bank Group institutions and offering a deep dive on a topic of current interest. This year, the specific topic will be World Bank ASA and IFC AS, which is expected to contribute to the dialogue on further strengthening the Bank Group's work on knowledge and learning. It will be undertaken in consultation with the recently established Knowledge and Learning Department and Outcomes Department, among others.

3. Questions and Components

3.1 Two key questions that *RAP 2025* will address are as follows:

- How have IEG country and project ratings changed over time and across countries and projects? This question will be analyzed through six components (components 1–6), which are outlined in figure 3.1.
- How have World Bank ASA and IFC AS contributed to and influenced public and private sector client outcomes?
 - What has been the use and influence of World Bank ASA in client countries and within the World Bank, and how has it been monitored? How can the use and influence of ASA and its monitoring be enhanced in the future? These questions will be analyzed through three components (components 7–9; figure 3.1).
 - What does the evidence show in terms of IFC AS contributions to both governments (enabling environment advisory) and private sector clients (firm-level advisory)? This question will be analyzed through three components (components 10–12), which are outlined in figure 3.1. The synthesis report will summarize evidence and identify cross-cutting findings with respect to these key questions.

Figure 3.1. Questions and Analytic Components in *Results and Performance of the World Bank Group 2025*



Source: Independent Evaluation Group.

Note: AS = advisory services; ASA = advisory services and analytics; CY = calendar year; IEG = Independent Evaluation Group; IFC = International Finance Corporation; IPF = investment project financing; MIGA = Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency.

4. Scope

4.1 The above questions and analytic components define the scope of *RAP 2025* and will be addressed as follows:

- The first question will be addressed by presenting and describing trends in country program and project ratings. This will be done based on IEG's validations of the Bank Group's self-evaluations and by analyzing the findings and lessons from IEG validations of projects and Country Program Evaluations (CPEs). Component 1 presents trends in IEG ratings at both the overall level and across subgroups. Component 2 describes trends in the types of outcomes

pursued by Bank Group projects. Within the context of outcome types, the report will assess progress toward the identification and tracking of outcome indicators in IFC's Anticipated Impact Measurement and Monitoring (AIMM) system,¹ which is IFC's ex ante analysis and monitoring tool for development outcomes. Component 3 describes factors linked to the performance of IFC investment and Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA) projects. Component 4 will identify factors specific to work quality and additionality that are associated with the development outcome ratings of IFC investment projects based on IEG validations of IFC self-evaluated projects, as well as independent IFC investment project evaluations by IEG (see appendix D for definitions of IFC work quality and IFC additionality for IFC investment projects). Component 5 will synthesize lessons based on IEG validations of MIGA self-evaluations for the following strategic areas in MIGA that exhibit weaker performance: the International Development Association and Sub-Saharan Africa. Component 6 will describe changes in country program ratings and, to the extent possible, will analyze drivers of country-level performance and synthesize lessons from good practice.

- The second question will be addressed by synthesizing evidence from IEG's CPEs, Completion and Learning Review Validations (CLRVs),² and corporate, sector, and thematic evaluations. The *RAP* will also review the World Bank's Completion and Learning Reviews and the country-specific ASA population launched during FY 2017–24 and closed as of June 24, 2025.³ Component 7 will analyze types of ASA use, along with pathways of ASA use and influence. Component 8 will analyze how the World Bank monitors the use and influence of ASA. Component 9 will distill ways to enhance the use and influence of ASA and AS and their monitoring. In addition, Component 9 will reflect the organization and governance structure of IFC AS.
- As part of the background analysis for the second question (2a), the team will present a breakdown of World Bank ASA, such as by activity type—including ASA (core analytics, extended core analytics, and other analytics)—and by financing type (such as World Bank budget financing and trust fund financing). In addition, as part of the background analysis, the team will present the similarities and differences between World Bank ASA and IFC AS.
- As part of the second question (2b), the team will synthesize evidence mainly from IEG project-level validations of IFC AS self-evaluations on contributions of IFC AS to both governments (enabling environment advisory) and private sector clients (firm-level advisory). IFC is the only multilateral development financial institution that has been systematically conducting self-evaluations of all its AS client-facing projects that have been completed since 2008. IEG has been

conducting project-level validations of a sample of IFC AS self-evaluations since 2008. IEG's project-level validations of IFC AS self-evaluations are therefore well tested, enabling the *RAP* to conduct detailed analysis of IFC AS projects. IEG draws a random stratified representative sample (51 percent) annually from among IFC AS projects that have been self-evaluated by IFC in the previous fiscal year. IEG independently validates IFC's self-evaluations annually. For the purposes of the *RAP*, IFC AS analysis can be categorized into IFC AS contributions to governments (enabling environment advisory; component 10), which mainly focuses on contributions to policy reforms (for example, reforms related to the business enabling environment or financial infrastructure), and IFC AS contributions to private sector clients (primarily firm-level advisory; components 11 and 12). Component 11 will identify factors linked to the performance of IFC AS, mainly in the Financial Institutions Group (FIG). Given the limited time and budget, FIG was chosen as a starting point because it is a fairly homogenous business line and is the largest sector in IFC; therefore, it will help IEG to set the stage for the coding of factors linked to the performance of IFC AS projects in other sectors in the future. Component 12 will distill lessons on linkages between IFC AS and IFC investment projects. In addition, synergies between ASA and AS will also be discussed.

5. Approach and Methodology

5.1 *RAP 2025* will apply a mix of methods (see appendix G for a detailed description of sampling, data sources, methods, strengths, and limitations). The mix of methods will include text analysis and statistical analysis, as well as manual review and coding of relevant documents. Text analysis will adopt an artificial intelligence (AI)-assisted approach, using embedding models to identify relevant content and generative AI to support validation, summarization, and interpretation of the text. Once the relevant text is identified, the sentiment analysis will be applied to assess whether the language expresses a generally positive or negative tone. The statistical analysis will include descriptive statistics, correlation analysis, and tests of statistical significance to examine patterns and differences across subgroups. Given that the *RAP* product is meant to synthesize existing evidence rather than collecting primary data, conducting structured interviews or case studies to collect primary data will be beyond its scope. IEG can, however, engage with Bank Group counterparts regarding evidence emerging from the *RAP* analysis. In consultation with the Board of Executive Directors, *RAP 2025* will consider whether to provide recommendations for enhancing the Bank Group's development effectiveness. Appendixes D through F provide the definitions of ratings and outline the analytic frameworks used in *RAP 2025*.

5.2 Bank Group institutions employ different frameworks and methodologies when rating projects. World Bank projects use an objective-based methodology to derive project performance ratings. These ratings summarize the World Bank's self-evaluation and IEG's validation into values that enable aggregation across projects. Similarly, IFC's AS project performance ratings are derived from an objective-based methodology, which establishes minimum thresholds for rating and assessing these projects' effectiveness. By contrast, the evaluation systems and performance ratings for IFC's investment projects and MIGA's guarantee projects are based on both objective and market or industry benchmark methodology, particularly for measuring financial performance to ensure the sustainability of IFC investments and MIGA guarantees in their respective markets. All methodologies align with good practice standards for evaluating public and private sector projects, as established by the Evaluation Cooperation Group of multilateral development banks, except for technical assistance and AS, which do not yet have established good practice standards (ECG 2012).⁴ The interest of the Board of Executive Directors in exploring the possibility of aligning rating methodologies across Bank Group institutions is a topic proposed for future discussion within the Evaluation Cooperation Group.

Question 1: How have IEG country and project ratings changed over time and across countries and projects?

5.3 To assess how outcomes and Bank performance have evolved, *RAP 2025* will analyze rating data using both descriptive and statistical methods. The trend analysis will examine (i) efficacy, outcome, and Bank performance ratings for all lending projects and (ii) monitoring and evaluation quality ratings for investment project financing and Program-for-Results projects only—both annually and over a three-year rolling period with a cutoff date of June 30, 2025. Ratings will be disaggregated by Region, Practice Group, lending group, fragile and conflict-affected situations (FCS), small states, size of commitments, and project length. Changes in performance will be explored through decomposition analysis, distinguishing between shifts within subgroups and changes in portfolio composition. Where relevant, statistical tests will be used to assess whether observed differences in ratings over time or across subgroups are significant. These methods will help provide a consistent and comparable assessment of trends while addressing changes in the composition and characteristics of the lending portfolio.

5.4 *RAP 2025* will examine the types of results that World Bank projects aim to achieve. To do so, it will continue to identify patterns in the intended outcomes defined in project objectives. The typology, developed for *RAP 2021*, includes 16 outcome types derived from typical project theories of change and select corporate priorities (see appendix E). In line with previous *RAPs*, the coding will be based on the statements of objectives. This year, we will apply a retrieval-augmented generation approach, using

large language models to validate relevant text identified for each outcome type through embedding-based similarity, alongside manual review, to ensure accuracy and contextual understanding. The analysis will review how outcome types vary across subgroups and over time, providing insights into the kinds of results projects aim to achieve in different contexts, including FCS.

5.5 For IFC investment projects and IFC AS projects, the report will analyze the trends in performance ratings over a three-year rolling average; for MIGA guarantee projects, the report will analyze the trends in performance ratings over a six-year rolling average because of the small number of projects evaluated and validated annually.⁵ The descriptive analysis will involve a breakdown of performance ratings for IFC investment projects, IFC AS projects, and MIGA guarantee projects across various subgroups with a cutoff date of June 30, 2025. These subgroups include Region, FCS, country lending group (the International Development Association and blend), investment instrument type (loan and equity), investment size, industry group (for IFC investments), and sector (for MIGA). Continuing from previous *RAPs*, the report will analyze the performance of IFC investment projects in terms of work quality, additionality, and investment outcome and their association with project development outcomes (see appendix D for definitions of IFC work quality, IFC additionality, and IFC investment outcomes for IFC investment projects). The report will also analyze the performance of IFC AS projects in terms of work quality and of role and contribution, as well as their association with project development effectiveness (see appendix D for definitions of IFC work quality and IFC role and contribution for IFC AS projects). *RAP 2025* will conduct a desk-based review of MIGA guarantee projects evaluated and validated by IEG between FY19 and FY24 to synthesize lessons on what worked and did not work in the following strategic areas: the International Development Association and Sub-Saharan Africa.

5.6 *RAP 2025* will identify the intended outcome types for IFC investment and MIGA guarantee projects. *RAP 2025* will apply the 13-category typology developed by *RAP 2021* for both IFC investment projects evaluated and validated by IEG in calendar year (CY) 2022–24 and MIGA guarantee projects evaluated and validated by IEG in FY22–24 with a cutoff date of December 31, 2024 (see appendix E). The purpose of this analysis is to ensure continuity in the analysis of trends in outcome types. Outcome types will be identified through a desk-based review and content analysis of IEG project evaluation and validation documents. *RAP 2025* will assess the extent to which the outcomes of IFC investment and MIGA guarantee projects were achieved at evaluation by verifying the information in the IEG project evaluation and validation documents. In addition, the report will assess the extent to which the outcome indicators of IFC investment projects are identified and tracked by the AIMM system. The rationale behind this analysis is based on the findings from previous *RAPs*, which indicated that monitoring data were

not available for a significant number of outcomes for projects that predated AIMM. IFC's management claims that the introduction of the AIMM system in 2017 addressed this shortcoming. To test this hypothesis, *RAP 2025* will assess the extent to which the AIMM system is enhancing the identification and tracking of outcome indicators for both project- and market-level outcomes. The report will analyze 62 IFC investment projects evaluated and validated by IEG in CY22–24 with “live” AIMM scores (projects to which IFC assigned ex ante AIMM scores at Board approval). This is the universe of IFC investment projects evaluated and validated by IEG with live AIMM scores in CY22–24 as of February 28, 2025. In the case of MIGA, there are no projects with live Impact Measurement and Project Assessment Comparison Tool (IMPACT) scores—MIGA's ex ante impact measurement tool—in FY22–24 as of February 28, 2025.⁶

5.7 *RAP 2025* will identify the factors linked to performance for IFC investment and MIGA guarantee projects. This will include (i) IFC investment projects evaluated and validated by IEG in CY22–24 and (ii) MIGA guarantee projects evaluated and validated by IEG in FY22–24 with a cutoff date of December 31, 2024. Factors linked to performance will be identified through a desk-based review and content analysis of IEG project evaluation and validation documents. For each project, the team will manually identify the top three factors that are positively or negatively linked to project performance and classify them using the taxonomy of performance factors, consisting of five categories and 51 subcategories developed by the IEG Private Sector/Finance Evaluation Unit (see appendix F).

5.8 *RAP 2025* will identify factors specific to work quality and additionality that are associated with the development outcomes of IFC investment projects. This analysis is particularly important given the legacy issues related to work quality ratings and evidence of strong correlation among work quality, additionality, and development outcomes. This analysis will include IFC investment projects evaluated and validated by IEG in CY22–24 that are at both ends of the ratings spectrum for work quality and development outcomes. The positive end of the spectrum indicates projects with development outcomes rated highly successful or successful and work quality rated excellent or satisfactory (30 projects). The negative end of the spectrum indicates projects with development outcomes rated highly unsuccessful or unsuccessful and work quality rated unsatisfactory or partly unsatisfactory (41 projects). Factors linked to work quality will be identified through a desk-based review and content analysis of IEG project evaluation and validation documents. A similar desk-based review will be conducted to analyze IFC investment projects evaluated and validated by IEG in CY22–24 at both ends of the ratings spectrum for additionality and development outcomes—29 projects at the positive end of the spectrum and 36 projects at the negative end of the spectrum. This will focus on (i) the frequency of occurrences of financial and nonfinancial additionality

anticipated at Board approval, (ii) additionality realized (fully or partially) or unrealized, and (iii) the frequency of occurrences of unanticipated additionality (additionality not anticipated in the Board paper but materialized).

5.9 To understand how Bank Group outcome and performance ratings at the country level have changed across contexts, the *RAP* will undertake an analysis of trends and, to the extent possible, analyze the drivers of country-level performance and synthesize good practice lessons. The analysis will draw on the development effectiveness and World Bank Group performance ratings from CLRVs covering the period from FY14 to FY24 and finalized by IEG by June 30, 2025. Aligned with previous *RAPs*, a smoothing approach for the trend analysis will be used, whereby ratings from CLRVs are applied across all years of the relevant Country Partnership Framework. The descriptive analysis of ratings will disaggregate data according to breakdowns (for example, Region, FCS, non-FCS, income group, and lending group). In addition, the *RAP* will synthesize lessons from country programs based on CLRVs and CPEs.

Question 2: How have World Bank ASA and IFC AS contributed to and influenced public and private sector client outcomes?

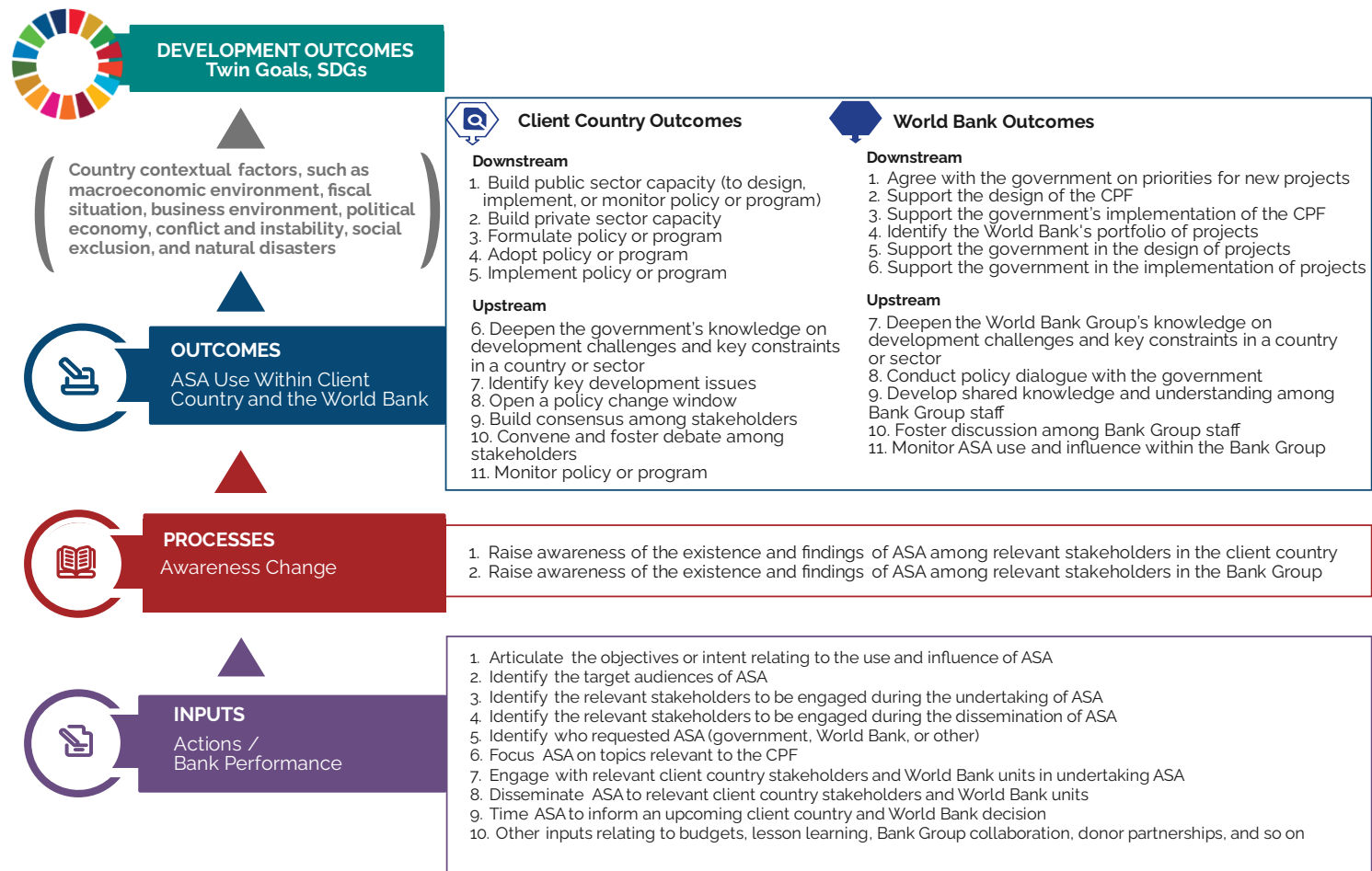
Question 2a: What has been the use and influence of World Bank ASA in client countries and within the World Bank, and how has it been monitored? How can the use and influence of ASA and its monitoring be enhanced in the future?

5.10 Three subquestions to answer the above overall question will include the following:

- What types of ASA results and outcomes were captured in IEG evaluations and World Bank self-evaluations, and what types of data and evidence were used?
- How clearly articulated were the objectives, audiences, engagement strategies, and theories of change relating to the use and influence of World Bank ASA?
- How were ASA use and influence monitored by the World Bank?

Figure 5.1 illustrates the results framework for ASA use and influence. The underlying subquestions are detailed in appendix B, together with an illustrative questionnaire for coding ASA use and influence based on IEG and World Bank sources. Output from the template will be used to present visualizations relating to patterns of ASA use and influence.

Figure 5.1. Results Framework for Advisory Services and Analytics Use and Influence



Source: Independent Evaluation Group.

Note: The pathways to development outcomes will inevitably be nonlinear and often occur with time lags, all the while being mediated by contextual factors. The overall framework applies both to analytics and advisory services with adaptation as warranted. ASA = advisory services and analytics; CPF = Country Partnership Framework; SDG = Sustainable Development Goal.

5.11 A twofold analysis—top-down and bottom-up—will be undertaken to answer the overall question and subquestions based on the illustrative questionnaire presented in appendix B. Instances of insufficient evidence of ASA use (absence of evidence) will be noted, as well as instances where ASA has likely not been used or monitored (evidence of absence). This will help the *RAP* identify areas for better monitoring of ASA use and influence in the future.

5.12 **Top-down analysis (drawing mostly on IEG sources).** To be undertaken for depth, using the country as the unit of analysis, the top-down analysis will track the overall country-level change that the World Bank ASA contributed to. This analysis will draw on IEG evaluations as a secondary source to document the evidence they present regarding each of the *RAP*'s questions on ASA use and influence. It will compile evidence from IEG's CPEs, CLRVs, and corporate, sector, and thematic evaluations and the World Bank's Completion and Learning Reviews. To the extent that CPEs and CLRVs trace pathways relating to ASA use and influence (for example, IEG's Morocco CPE), the *RAP* will highlight the role of ASA in contributing to development outcomes. Separately, evidence on ASA use and influence will also be compiled from IEG's corporate, sector, and thematic evaluations. In those cases where either the CPEs or CLRVs contain substantial references to World Bank ASA and IFC AS, the *RAP* will identify the extent of synergies between World Bank and IFC support.

5.13 The specific IEG evaluations that will be drawn on will include the following:

- All 22 completed CPEs for the period FY10–25 (up to March 2025). This will include the two most recent CPEs—Nepal and the Federal Republic of Somalia—but will exclude the clustered CPEs for small states and resource-rich countries.
- Twenty-one completed CLRVs for the period FY10–25 (up to March 2025) sampled purposively for this *RAP*.
- Twenty-two corporate, sector, and thematic evaluations completed up to March 2025 sampled purposively for this *RAP*.

5.14 **Bottom-up analysis (drawing mostly on World Bank sources).** To be undertaken for representativity, using ASA as the unit of analysis, the bottom-up analysis will be based on the country-specific ASA population launched during FY17–24 and closed as of June 24, 2025, totaling 5,720 ASA. The analysis will examine the pattern of ASA population and provide a breakdown by funding source, activity type (analytic and advisory), Region, Global Practice, and country characteristics.

5.15 **Desk reviews, including AI-assisted text analysis.** The synthesis of evidence on ASA use and influence will follow a two-part approach combining manual review and

AI-assisted text analysis. Text segments coded for ASA use and influence within predefined outcome areas under the top-down analysis will be analyzed and synthesized. Where a sufficient volume of relevant material is available across documents from the top-down analysis, generative AI will be used to support summarization and pattern identification. Meanwhile, a random sample of ASA activities will be analyzed using an AI-assisted approach. The text from “Activity Summary” and “Assessment” fields will be examined to address to what extent activities articulate ASA objectives related to use and influence and to what extent they describe how ASA use and influence were monitored.

Question 2b: What does the evidence show in terms of IFC AS contributions to both governments (enabling environment advisory) and private sector clients (firm-level advisory)?

5.16 For IFC AS, the report will analyze the following:

- **The contributions of IFC AS to policy reforms (enabling environment advisory).** The question that this analysis will address is, To what extent and how have IFC enabling environment AS projects contributed to policy reforms? To answer this question, IEG will conduct a desk-based review of IFC AS projects evaluated and validated by IEG between FY22 and FY24 that have objectives focusing on regulations. As part of this analysis, IEG will identify some of the key policy reforms targeted by IFC AS projects. The focus of these reforms can range from the investment climate to financial infrastructure. In addition, IEG will identify the status of these reforms (drafting, adoption, and implementation) based on the evidence from IEG evaluations and validations. IEG will synthesize lessons on what worked in terms of IFC AS contributions to policy reforms. IEG will also synthesize lessons on what did not work.
- **Factors linked to the performance of IFC AS in FIG (primarily firm-level advisory).** The question that this analysis will address is, What factors are associated with the performance of IFC AS projects in FIG? To answer this question, IEG will conduct a desk-based review to code factors linked to IFC AS performance only for FIG projects evaluated and validated by IEG in FY22–24 (36 projects). For each project, IEG will manually identify up to three key factors that are either positively or negatively linked to project performance and classify them using a pilot taxonomy of performance factors that will be developed by the IEG Private Sector/Finance Evaluation Unit. Given the limited time and budget, FIG was chosen as a starting point for the firm-level analysis because it is the largest sector in IFC, is fairly homogenous, and will help IEG to set the stage for the coding of IFC AS projects in other sectors in the future. IEG will

synthesize lessons on what worked and what did not work for the top three factors linked to IFC AS performance.

- **Distilling lessons on linkages⁷ between IFC AS and IFC investment projects (primarily firm-level advisory).** The question that this analysis will address is, How have IFC AS contributed to investment outcomes, and what role has the collaboration between IFC AS and investment teams played in achieving them? A total of 113 linked projects were evaluated and validated by IEG in 2019–24. Of these 113 linked projects, 31 projects have IEG evaluations and validations for both IFC investment and IFC AS projects, 23 projects have IEG evaluations and validations for IFC investment projects but not for IFC AS projects, and 59 have IEG evaluations and validations for IFC AS projects but not for IFC investment projects. For the purposes of *RAP 2025*, IEG will analyze the 31 linked projects with IEG evaluations and validations for both IFC investment and IFC AS projects in 2019–24 (that is, IEG validations of IFC self-evaluations or independent evaluations of investment projects that reached maturity in CY19–24 and IEG validations of self-evaluations of AS projects delivered by IFC in FY19–24). On the basis of a desk-based review of these 31 linked projects, IEG will synthesize lessons on what worked and what did not work on IFC AS contributions to investment outcomes and the extent of collaboration between IFC AS and IFC investment teams.

6. Limitations

6.1 In summarizing evidence from IEG’s validations of the World Bank self-evaluations, three important limitations are worth mentioning:

- As previously noted in *RAP 2023*, recent project cohorts are susceptible to selection bias. This arises because projects evaluated and validated shortly after closure tend to receive higher ratings compared with those that take longer to undergo evaluation. This recurring pattern is evident in past *RAP* reports. For example, the average rating for projects closed in FY19 initially stood at 4.1 in *RAP 2020* but decreased to 4.0 by *RAP 2023* as more, lower-rated projects were included. Consequently, because not all projects closed in FY24 will have finalized Implementation Completion and Results Reports and Implementation Completion and Results Report Reviews by the *RAP 2025* cutoff date, the results reported in the *RAP* should be interpreted with this in mind.
- Because the composition of projects varies from year to year, the *RAP* data set does not form a time series or panel in which each year is directly comparable. Each year’s cohort represents a unique mix of projects, making simple year-to-

year comparisons potentially misleading. This is especially true when one year includes a disproportionate share of projects from specific subgroups, such as FCS. To mitigate this, the decomposition analysis is used to distinguish between changes in portfolio composition and changes in performance within subgroups. In addition, using three-year rolling averages helps smooth out annual fluctuations and enables more meaningful comparisons over time.

- An improvement in World Bank project or country ratings does not necessarily indicate that development outcomes at the country level have improved. Country-level outcomes are shaped by many factors and actors, including the roles of government and other development partners. Therefore, higher ratings should not be interpreted as direct evidence of improved development results. Understanding how projects or country portfolios contribute to longer-term development outcomes requires further analysis beyond what ratings alone can show.
- Given that the *RAP* is a synthesis of existing evaluations and self-evaluations, its analysis will be based mainly on secondary sources rather than on new sources of evidence. Secondary sources do not all address ASA with the same depth or methodology. For example, ASA design documents do not always clearly specify the objectives or anticipated outcomes, and Activity Completion Summaries for ASA may not include evidence on ASA use or influence. Furthermore, to the extent that CPEs are selective in their sectoral coverage, the *RAP*'s analysis of CPEs will focus on ASA outcomes in these sectors.

6.2 Limitations are also identified for IFC investment, IFC AS, and MIGA guarantee projects:

- Unlike the World Bank, which validates 100 percent of closed projects in the portfolio, the *RAP*'s main source of evidence for IFC investment and IFC AS projects is a random sample that IEG evaluates and validates every year. IEG draws a random stratified representative sample (40 percent) annually from among IFC investment projects that were approved by the Board of Executive Directors five to seven years earlier and that reached early operating maturity (ensuring that sufficient information is available for the evaluation). During the calendar year, IFC investment staff self-evaluate all active IFC investment projects in the sample, and IEG independently validates them. IEG independently evaluates closed projects in the sample in lieu of IFC self-evaluations. Similarly, IEG draws a random stratified representative sample (51 percent) annually from all IFC AS projects that have been completed and self-evaluated by IFC in the previous fiscal year.

- The taxonomy of performance factors for IFC investment projects developed by the IEG Private Sector/Finance Evaluation Unit may require some adjustments because it has been fully tested for IFC investment projects in three industry groups (FIG, Disruptive Technologies and Funds, and Infrastructure and Natural Resources) and has been partially tested for projects in the Manufacturing, Agribusiness, and Services industry group.
- Given the limited time and budget, FIG was chosen as a starting point for the IFC AS analysis of factors linked to performance because it is the largest sector in IFC, is fairly homogenous, and will help IEG to set the stage for the coding of IFC AS projects in other sectors in the future.
- In the case of linked IFC investment and IFC AS projects, there will be situations where there are IEG evaluations and validations for IFC investment projects but not for IFC AS projects and vice versa. For the purposes of lessons on what worked and what did not work, IEG will conduct a desk-based review of all linked projects with IEG evaluations and validations for both IFC investment and IFC AS projects in 2019–24 (31 projects).
- As reported in *RAP 2024*, MIGA is behind on submitting self-evaluations of guarantee projects, which hinders both accountability and learning and prevents IEG from building an accurate picture of its overall development outcome ratings.⁸ The pending self-evaluations from MIGA mean that it is difficult to comment definitively on trends in development outcome ratings.
- IEG project-level evaluation and validation documents do not rate the intended outcomes pursued by IFC investment and MIGA guarantee projects. The objectives of IFC investment and MIGA guarantee projects are assessed but not rated because the IEG validations of the Expanded Project Supervision Reports are both objective based and benchmark based (based on market and industry standards). Long-term sustainability effects and trends are considered rather than focusing solely on the achievement of the intended objective.
- Although the empirical associations among IFC's work quality, additionality, and development outcome ratings are well established through correlation analysis, establishing causality among these factors may not be possible in *RAP 2025*. Both positive and negative factors, beyond IFC's work quality and additionality, can contribute to the development outcome ratings of IFC investment projects.

7. Engagement, Communication, and Dissemination

7.1 During the preparation of the Concept Note, the *RAP* team has engaged with the staff and management of the World Bank, IFC, and MIGA, and the team will continue to do so during the preparation of the *RAP* report. *RAP 2025* will be concise, and, like the 2024 report, it will provide separate appendixes of interest to Bank Group management, along with interactive tables using Tableau that allow for various Region, Global Practice, and country cuts. Similar to previous *RAPs*, blog posts, intranet features, and social media dissemination will also be considered, including at Evaluation Cooperation Group events involving the participation of multilateral development banks.

8. Resources

Timeline

8.1 The evaluation draft and IEG management review are planned for the first quarter of FY26. Bank Group management review and e-submission are planned for the third quarter of FY26.

Budget

8.2 The budget for delivering *RAP 2025* is US\$1,000,000, of which about US\$600,000 is for the new work on the deep dive on World Bank ASA and IFC AS.

Notes

¹ The AIMM system, launched in July 2017, is IFC's ex ante analysis and monitoring system. Potential projects are rated ex ante and selected based on their expected development outcomes. The AIMM system assesses project outcomes in terms of how project beneficiaries, including employees, customers, and suppliers, are affected. It also assesses the effects of project outcomes on market creation in terms of enhancing competitiveness, resilience, integration, inclusiveness, and sustainability. An ex ante AIMM score is assigned in the year when the project is approved. After early monitoring maturity based on AIMM's definition, the portfolio score is updated for the first time; each year after that, a new portfolio score is assigned. When the project reaches AIMM's target year, often coinciding with the time of the preparation of the selected (40 percent sample) IFC self-evaluation Expanded Project Supervision Report, a terminal portfolio score is assigned, and the same score is carried over until the end of the financial relationship with the client.

² The Completion and Learning Review Validation (CLRV) was called the Completion and Learning Review Review (CLRR) before May 1, 2023. No change was made to the methodology.

³ Effective July 11, 2016, the World Bank consolidated its five ASA product lines into a single ASA product line.

⁴ Reforms in the Bank Group self-evaluation and IEG validation practices will be discussed as part of the Evolution Agenda. Updates on the implementation of these reforms will inform the future *RAPs*.

⁵ MIGA self-evaluation and independent validation covers 100 percent of its guarantee projects. However, the cohort of self-evaluation and independent validation is small because a limited number of MIGA guarantees reach maturity and become eligible for self-evaluation and validation every year.

⁶ MIGA launched IMPACT, an ex ante impact measurement tool, in FY20. Although both IMPACT and AIMM, IFC's ex ante monitoring tool, track project outcomes, IMPACT tracks foreign investment, whereas AIMM tracks market creation.

⁷ It should be noted that not all IFC AS are intended to lead directly to IFC investments.

⁸ In the FY22 program, MIGA delivered 13 out of 19 self-evaluations. Of these 13 self-evaluations, 10 were validated by IEG (3 MIGA self-evaluations were delivered in June 2025 and are currently being validated by IEG). In the FY23 program, MIGA delivered 8 out of 15 self-evaluations. All but 1 were validated by IEG (1 MIGA self-evaluation was delivered in March 2025 and is currently being validated by IEG). In the FY24 program, MIGA delivered 0 out of 27 self-evaluations.

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Appendix A. Definitions of World Bank Advisory Services and Analytics and International Finance Corporation Advisory Services

World Bank advisory services and analytics (ASA) and International Finance Corporation (IFC) advisory services (AS) for the *Results and Performance of the World Bank Group (RAP)* are described in this appendix.

World Bank analytics refers to nonlending activities (analytic reports, policy notes, and so on) with a development objective focusing on the creation of new knowledge to help shape client or global development strategies, policies, and reforms. Analytics includes (i) country analytics (which includes core analytics, extended core analytics, and other analytics) and (ii) regional and global analytics, including flagships (such as World Development Reports) and other non-country-specific development analytics, and Good Practice Notes, methodology, and tool kits.

World Bank core analytics comprises five World Bank reports: (i) Country Climate and Development Report, (ii) Poverty and Equity Assessment, (iii) Country Growth and Jobs Report (CEM 3.0), (iv) Public Finance Review, and (v) Country Private Sector Diagnostic 2.0. **Extended core analytics** includes, for example, Agriculture Sector Review, Country Environment Assessment, Debt Management Performance Assessment, Fiduciary Assessment, Financial Sector Assessment Program, Human Capital Review, Infrastructure Sector Assessment Program, Pandemic Preparedness Diagnostics, Sustainable Cities Review, and Risk and Resilience Assessment. Finally, **other analytics** includes all other analytic reports and policy notes.

World Bank advisory services refers to nonlending activities (hands-on advice, implementation advice or capacity building, training, and events or forums, knowledge-sharing workshops, or training programs) with a development objective focusing on the application of preexisting knowledge, with varying degrees of customization (World Bank n.d.).

IFC AS. The term *advisory* refers to engagements in which IFC provides a client with advice (for example, consulting services and technical assistance) on a specific subject or matter. The scope of IFC's client-facing advisory operations includes (i) enabling environment advisory: IFC provides advice to public or private sector entities to improve the conditions, policies, or institutions that affect private firms in a particular market or sector; (ii) firm-level advisory: IFC provides advice to private sector companies or state-owned enterprises to build their capacity, expand their impact, or manage risks; and (iii) transaction advisory: IFC provides advice to public sector entities on developing, structuring, and competitively tendering public-private partnerships, or

supports private sector companies with initiating and executing mergers, acquisitions, and investment partnerships.

Not all IFC AS require implementation. The following are the examples of IFC AS that do not require implementation; therefore, their self-evaluations are not validated by the Independent Evaluation Group:

- **Client preparation.** Limited-scope engagement with a postconcept (IFC) investment client to help overcome specific issues (for example, corporate governance and environmental and social) that are blocking an IFC investment.
- **Diagnostic and seed.** Studies to deepen understanding of opportunities and challenges in relation to a market or sector, including information on sector structure, competition, cost structure, regulatory, and environmental and social issues.
- **Knowledge and product development.** Internally focused activities to develop or enhance a standardized IFC product or approach, which could be replicated and deployed in client-facing projects. This may include (i) preparing a knowledge repository to support client delivery (for example, tool kits, training modules, product strategy, market studies, and staff training); (ii) developing quality marketing materials (for example, pitchbooks and external website); (iii) limited-scope client preparation activities to gauge market interest and refine product or approach; and (iv) limited pilot testing of a new product or tool with external client (with implementation support leading to outcomes) for which cumulative expenses do not exceed 10 percent of total approved IFC budget.

The Independent Evaluation Group validates only self-evaluations of IFC AS projects that require implementation. These IFC AS projects are categorized as “client/sector development.” Examples include the following:

- In-depth engagement with an existing or potential (IFC) investment client(s)—leading to direct development outcomes and likely affecting results—to build capacity and improve performance, focusing on resolving core issues and bottlenecks in client operations and expanding growth opportunities.
- In-depth engagement with an existing or potential (IFC) client(s)—leading to direct development outcomes and likely affecting results—to help build capacity in innovative or strategically relevant areas, such as climate and gender, that are expected to generate demonstration effect, facilitate development impact, or strengthen IFC’s market credibility.

- In-depth engagement with a public or private sector (IFC) client(s)—leading to direct development outcomes and likely affecting results—to support the development of a target sector and enable new investment opportunities by addressing complex development challenges. This may include support in reforming the legal or regulatory framework to enable private sector investment, support in strengthening the capacity of industry institutions to set standards, and support in facilitating public and private partnerships to improve basic services, such as energy, transportation, health, education, and so on.

Reference

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Appendix B. Overall Question and Subquestions on World Bank Advisory Services and Analytics

This appendix discusses how the overall question of the *Results and Performance of the World Bank Group (RAP)* on advisory services and analytics (ASA) use and influence will be addressed. The RAP's overall question and subquestions on ASA use are as follows.

Overall Question

What has been the use and influence of World Bank ASA in client countries and within the World Bank and how has it been monitored? How can the use and influence of ASA and its monitoring be enhanced in the future?

- What types of ASA results and outcomes were captured in World Bank self-evaluations and Independent Evaluation Group (IEG) evaluations with what types of data and evidence?
- At initiation of the ASA, how clearly articulated were the objectives, audiences, engagement strategies, and theories of change relating to the use and influence of World Bank ASA?
- How was the ASA use and influence monitored by the World Bank?

Structure

Preliminary data. The Preliminary Data section will capture basic information about the country, ASA, and IEG evaluation or World Bank document being reviewed.

Illustrative questionnaire. The questionnaire will summarize narrative data relating to the types of results and outcomes pertaining to ASA use and influence, factors underpinning use and influence (or lack thereof), and evidence and data gaps relating to the analysis of ASA use and influence.

Instruments and Types of Analysis

The main instrument to be used (desk review) and types of analysis—top-down and bottom-up—are described in this section, including data sources (table B.1).

Table B.1. Preliminary Data

Country Name
Reference document being reviewed and date of document
Time period of World Bank support being assessed in the document
Link to document
For CPE, CLRV, CPF, and CLR, note sectoral coverage and reason for that coverage
Sectors covered by each ASA and AS mentioned in the text of the document
How many ASA and AS noted in the text of the document (please list with titles of each ASA and AS noted in the text of the document and the full list of ASA and AS presented in the appendix, if applicable)
For each ASA and AS noted in the text of the document, please indicate the type with the respective titles. The various types are as follows:
• World Bank ASA (including hands-on advice, implementation advice or capacity building, training, and events or forums, knowledge-sharing workshops, or training programs) • IFC AS • Country analytics (including core, extended core, sector-specific diagnostics and analytics, and other) • Global and regional analytics (note whether a global benchmarking study or a global or regional knowledge product, and note the sector) • CPFs (number) with their period covered in the relevant document • Country contextual factors (such as macroeconomic environment, fiscal situation, business environment, political economy, conflict and instability, social exclusion, and natural disasters)
Number of ASA mentioned in the document (any breakdown between AS versus analytics to be captured)
IFC: Number of AS mentioned in CPE
MIGA: Number of AS mentioned in CPF

Source: Independent Evaluation Group.

Note: AS = advisory services; ASA = advisory services and analytics; CLR = Completion and Learning Review; CLRV = Completion and Learning Review Validation; CPE = Country Program Evaluation; CPF = Country Partnership Framework; IFC = International Finance Corporation; MIGA = Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency.

Illustrative Questionnaire

Outcomes

A. What has been the use and influence of World Bank ASA and International Finance Corporation (IFC) advisory services in client countries, and how has it been monitored with regard to the following?

Downstream

1. Building public sector capacity (to design, implement, or monitor policy or program; can apply to both World Bank ASA and IFC advisory services)
2. Building private sector capacity (for IFC client-facing advisory services)
3. Formulating policy or program
4. Adopting policy or program
5. Implementing policy or program

Upstream

6. Deepening the government's knowledge on development challenges and key constraints in a country or sector
7. Identifying key development issues
8. Opening a policy change window
9. Building consensus among stakeholders
10. Convening and fostering debate among stakeholders
11. Monitoring policy or program

B. What has been the use and influence of World Bank ASA within the World Bank, and how has it been monitored with regard to the following?

Downstream

12. Agreeing with the government on priorities for new projects
13. Supporting the design of the Country Partnership Framework
14. Supporting the government's implementation of the Country Partnership Framework
15. Identifying the World Bank's portfolio of projects (development policy financing, investment project financing, and Program-for-Results)
16. Supporting the government in the design of projects (development policy financing, investment project financing, and Program-for-Results)
17. Supporting the government in the implementation of projects (development policy financing, investment project financing, and Program-for-Results)

Upstream

18. Deepening the World Bank Group's knowledge on development challenges and key constraints in a country or sector
19. Conducting policy dialogue with the government
20. Developing shared understanding among Bank Group staff
21. Fostering discussion among Bank Group staff
22. Monitoring ASA use and influence within the Bank Group

Processes

To what extent has attention been given to the following?

1. Raising awareness about the existence or findings of the ASA among relevant stakeholders in the client country or the Bank Group
2. Developing knowledge or skills among relevant stakeholders in the client country or the Bank Group

Inputs

To what extent has attention been given to the following?

1. Articulating the objectives or intent relating to the use and influence of the ASA
2. Identifying the target audiences of the ASA
3. Identifying the relevant stakeholders to be engaged during the undertaking of the ASA
4. Identifying the relevant stakeholders to be engaged during dissemination of the ASA
5. Identifying who requested the ASA (government, the World Bank, or other)
6. Focusing the ASA on topics relevant to the Country Partnership Framework
7. Engaging with relevant client-country stakeholders in undertaking the ASA
8. Engaging with relevant World Bank units in undertaking the ASA
9. Disseminating the ASA to relevant client-country stakeholders
10. Disseminating the ASA to relevant World Bank units
11. Timing the ASA to inform an upcoming decision in the client country
12. Timing the ASA to inform an upcoming decision in the World Bank
13. Ensuring that World Bank staff preparing the ASA have sufficient budgets, staff time, signaling at review meetings, guidance notes, and advice from peer reviewers
14. Learning lessons on ASA use and influence

One Bank Group collaboration and donor partnerships:

15. Ensuring collaboration among the World Bank, IFC, and the Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency in preparing the ASA
16. ASA leading to collaborative work among the World Bank, IFC, and the Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency
17. World Bank ASA informing the work of IFC and the Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency
18. Ensuring partnership between the World Bank and other donors in undertaking the ASA

Instruments and Types of Analyses

The *RAP* will address the overall question and the related subquestions through desk reviews, including artificial intelligence-enabled text analytics with the human in the loop.

Two types of analyses will be conducted:

1. Analysis of IEG evaluations (top-down analysis with the country as the unit of analysis)
2. Analysis of ASA text data (bottom-up analysis with ASA as the unit of analysis)

Analysis of IEG evaluations. As much evidence as is available for each of the subquestions will be harvested from the IEG evaluations:

- All 22 completed Country Program Evaluations for the period FY 2010–25 (up to March 2025). This will include the two most recent Country Program Evaluations, Nepal and the Federal Republic of Somalia, but will exclude the two clustered Country Program Evaluations for small states and resource-rich countries given that the depth of evidence on ASA use for individual countries in the cluster is likely to be scant.
- Twenty-one completed Completion and Learning Review Validations for the period FY10–25 (up to March 2025) sampled purposively for this *RAP*.
- Twenty-two corporate, sector, and thematic evaluations completed up to March 2025 sampled purposively for this *RAP*.

Analysis of ASA text data. Text data of individual ASA (rather than individual documents in isolation) will be reviewed to track the use ASA in World Bank strategies or projects. The ASA text data will include activity summary and assessment. The population of ASA, which refers to the country-specific ASA launched during FY17–24

and closed as of June 24, 2025, numbered 5,720. In terms of the types of ASA, the focus will be on country analytics, and within country analytics, all three types of country analytics (that is, core analytics, extended core analytics, and other analytics) will be covered. A sample of analytic ASA activities will be analyzed using an artificial intelligence–assisted approach. The text from “Activity Summary” and “Assessment” fields will be examined to address to what extent activities articulate ASA objectives related to use and influence and to what extent they describe how ASA use and influence will be monitored.

Appendix C. Overall Question and Subquestions on International Finance Corporation Advisory Services

This appendix discusses how the question of the *Results and Performance of the World Bank Group (RAP)* on International Finance Corporation (IFC) advisory services (AS) use will be addressed.

Overall Question

What does the evidence show in terms of IFC AS contributions to both governments (enabling environment advisory) and private sector clients (firm-level advisory)?

Subquestion 1

To what extent and how have IFC enabling environment AS projects contributed to policy reforms (enabling environment advisory)?

Source of evidence. It includes Independent Evaluation Group (IEG) evaluations and validations in FY 2022–24 of 61 IFC AS projects that have objectives focusing on regulations.

Methods and approach. IEG will conduct a desk-based review of IFC AS projects evaluated and validated by IEG between FY22 and FY24 that have objectives focusing on regulations. As part of this analysis, IEG will identify some of the key policy reforms targeted by IFC AS projects. These can range from reforms in investment climate to financial infrastructure. In addition, IEG will identify the status of these reforms (drafting, adoption, and implementation) based on the evidence from IEG evaluations and validations. IEG will synthesize lessons on what worked in terms of IFC AS contributions to policy reforms and will also synthesize lessons on what did not work.

Subquestion 2

What factors are associated with the performance of IFC AS projects in the Financial Institutions Group (primarily firm-level advisory)?

Source of evidence. It includes IEG evaluations and validations in FY22–24 of 36 IFC AS projects in the Financial Institutions Group.

Methods and approach. IEG will conduct a desk-based review to code factors linked to IFC AS performance only for Financial Institutions Group projects evaluated and validated by IEG in FY22–24. For each project, IEG will manually identify up to three factors that are positively or negatively linked to project performance and classify them

using a pilot taxonomy of performance factors that will be developed by the IEG Private Sector/Finance Evaluation Unit. IEG will synthesize lessons on what worked and what did not work for the top three factors linked to IFC AS performance.

Limitation. Given the limited time and budget, the Financial Institutions Group was chosen as a starting point for IFC AS analysis of factors linked to performance because it is the largest sector in IFC, is fairly homogenous, and will help IEG to set the stage for the coding of IFC AS projects in other sectors in the future.

Subquestion 3

How have IFC AS contributed to investment outcomes, and what role has the collaboration between IFC AS and investment teams played in achieving them (primarily firm-level advisory)?

Source of evidence. It includes IEG evaluations and validations of linked IFC investment projects in calendar years 2019–24 and IFC AS projects in FY19–24 (31 linked projects have IEG evaluations and validations for both IFC investment and IFC AS projects).

Methods and approach. The questions that this analysis will address are the following: How have IFC AS contributed to investment outcomes? What is the extent of collaboration between IFC AS and IFC investment teams? A total of 113 linked projects were evaluated and validated by IEG in 2019–24. Of these 113 linked projects, 31 projects have IEG evaluations and validations for both IFC investment and IFC AS projects, 23 projects have IEG evaluations and validations only for IFC investment projects but not for IFC AS projects, and 59 have IEG evaluations and validations only for IFC AS projects but not for IFC investment projects. For the purposes of *RAP 2025*, IEG will analyze the 31 linked projects with IEG evaluations and validations for both IFC investment and IFC AS projects in 2019–24 (that is, IEG validations of IFC self-evaluations or independent evaluations of investment projects that reached maturity in calendar years 2019–24 and IEG validations of self-evaluations of AS projects delivered by IFC in FY19–24). On the basis of a desk-based review of these 31 linked projects, IEG will synthesize lessons on what worked and what did not work on IFC AS contributions to investment outcomes and the extent of collaboration between IFC AS and IFC investment teams.

Limitation. In the case of linked IFC investment and IFC AS projects, there will be situations where there are IEG evaluations and validations for IFC investment projects but not for IFC AS projects and vice versa. For the purposes of lessons on what worked and what did not work, IEG will conduct a desk-based review of all linked projects with IEG evaluations and validations for both IFC investment and IFC AS projects in 2019–24 (31 projects).

Appendix D. Ratings Framework for World Bank Group Projects

This appendix summarizes the results and performance ratings for the World Bank, International Finance Corporation (IFC) investment projects, IFC advisory services (AS) projects, and Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA) guarantee projects in *Results and Performance of the World Bank Group 2025*. For details about data sources, data collection methods, and data analysis, refer to appendix G.

World Bank

Project ratings are assigned based on a shared approach defined between management and the Independent Evaluation Group (IEG). The Implementation Completion and Results Reports prepared by World Bank staff are essential self-evaluation tools to assess projects and operations. As part of its validation work, IEG conducts independent reviews of the Implementation Completion and Results Reports, known as Implementation Completion and Results Report Reviews. These reviews critically validate the evidence, results, and ratings of the Implementation Completion and Results Reports, aligning them with the project's design documents as necessary. IEG also conducts fieldwork to learn about selected World Bank lending projects annually through Project Performance Assessment Reports. Project performance ratings for World Bank projects are derived from an objective-based methodology that, together with performance rating scales and criteria, was agreed on with Operations Policy and Country Services. Ratings divide the World Bank's self-evaluation and IEG's validation narratives into categories or values that enable aggregation across projects. The ratings used by Implementation Completion and Results Report Reviews and Project Performance Assessment Reports are provided in table D.1 and figure D.1.

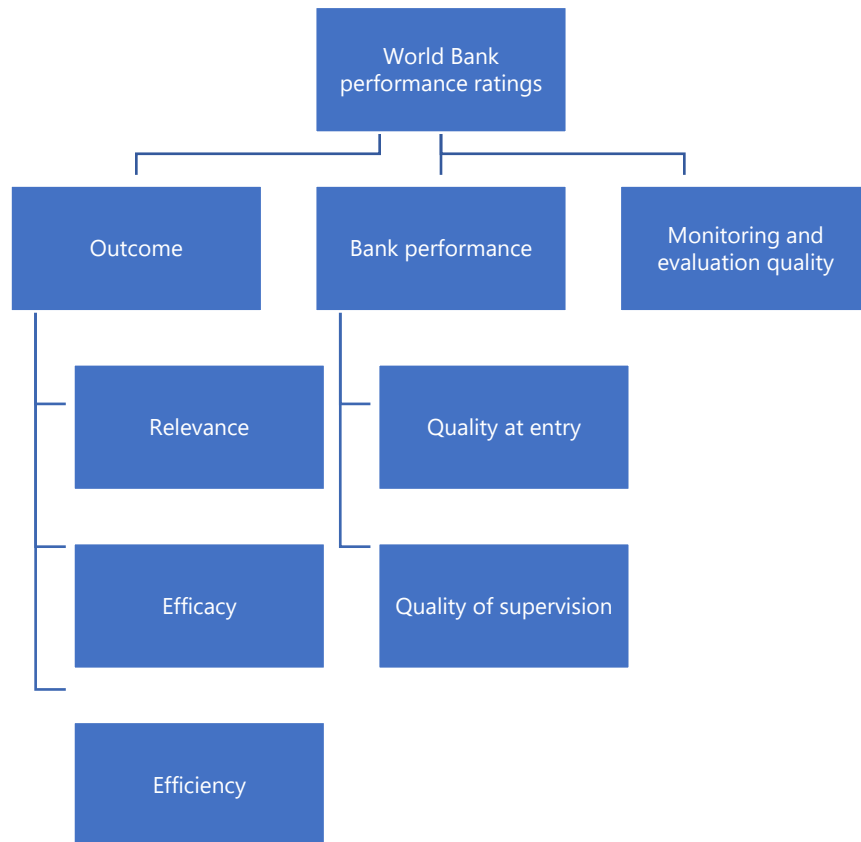
Table D.1. World Bank Project Performance Rating Indicators

Rating	Definition	Scale
Outcome	The extent to which a project efficiently achieved, or was expected to achieve, its relevant objectives. The outcome rating integrates three underlying dimensions: relevance, efficacy (objectives achievement), and efficiency.	Six-point: • Highly satisfactory • Satisfactory • Moderately satisfactory • Moderately unsatisfactory • Unsatisfactory • Highly unsatisfactory
Relevance	The extent to which a project's objectives align with current World Bank country strategies at the time of project closing.	Four-point: • High • Substantial • Modest • Negligible

Rating	Definition	Scale
Efficacy	The extent to which the project's objectives were achieved, or are expected to be achieved, taking into account their relative importance and attributability to the activities or actions supported by the project. It is rated for each individual objective and at the overall level.	Four-point: • High • Substantial • Modest • Negligible
Efficiency	A measure of how economic resources and inputs are converted to results. It assesses whether the costs involved in achieving project objectives were reasonable in comparison with the benefits and recognized norms (value for money).	Four-point: • High • Substantial • Modest • Negligible
Bank performance	The extent to which World Bank services ensured quality project design and supported effective implementation through appropriate supervision to achieve development outcomes.	Six-point: • Highly satisfactory • Satisfactory • Moderately satisfactory • Moderately unsatisfactory • Unsatisfactory • Highly unsatisfactory
Quality at entry (design)	The extent to which the World Bank identified, facilitated preparation of, and appraised the project to maximize the likelihood of achieving planned development outcomes while maintaining consistency with the World Bank's fiduciary role. (Note that the evaluation methodology for development policy financing projects changed in 2020, redefining this rating as "design.")	Six-point: • Highly satisfactory • Satisfactory • Moderately satisfactory • Moderately unsatisfactory • Unsatisfactory • Highly unsatisfactory
Quality of supervision (implementation)	The extent to which the World Bank proactively identified and addressed threats to the achievement of relevant development outcomes and the World Bank's fiduciary role. (Note that the evaluation methodology for development policy financing projects changed in 2020, redefining this rating as "implementation.")	Six-point: • Highly satisfactory • Satisfactory • Moderately satisfactory • Moderately unsatisfactory • Unsatisfactory • Highly unsatisfactory
Monitoring and evaluation quality	The quality of the project's monitoring and evaluation design, implementation, and use of results to improve performance. (Note that the evaluation methodology for development policy financing projects changed in 2020, eliminating this rating for development policy financing projects.)	Four-point: • High • Substantial • Modest • Negligible

Source: Independent Evaluation Group Implementation Completion and Results Report Review evaluation guidelines.

Figure D.1. Performance Ratings in World Bank Investment Projects



Source: Independent Evaluation Group.

Note: This is the ratings structure for investment project financing and Program-for-Results; development policy financing has a slightly modified ratings structure.

International Finance Corporation Investments

The main source of evidence for analyzing the trends in IFC investment performance ratings is the Expanded Project Supervision Reports (XPSRs) evaluated by IFC and validated by IEG. IEG draws a random stratified representative sample (40 percent) annually from among IFC investment projects that were approved by the Board of Executive Directors five years earlier and that reached early operating maturity. During the calendar year, IFC investment staff evaluate all active IFC investment projects selected in the sample using XPSRs, and IEG independently validates them using Evaluative Notes. For closed projects¹ selected in the sample, IEG prepares a Project Evaluation Summary in lieu of an XPSR. To conduct the project evaluation and

¹ All operational and financial activities and legal obligations associated with the project are completed.

validation, IFC and IEG staff refer to XPSR guidelines that provide the evaluation framework and performance rating criteria.

The evaluation system and performance ratings for IFC projects are both objective based and benchmark based. In addition to the focus on the achievement of expected objectives stated in the Board report at approval, IFC investment project performance is assessed against comparators, such as performance of peer companies, the market, and similar industries, and considers unintended outcomes (both positive and negative).

The main performance assessment dimensions for IFC investment projects are development outcomes, IFC additionality, IFC investment outcome, and IFC work quality (figure D.2). In addition, XPSR assesses the sustainability of development and IFC investment outcomes in the longer run by examining project prospects and investment return expectations over the remaining life of the project:

- Development outcome synthesizes a project's performance across four dimensions: project business performance, economic sustainability, environmental and social effects, and private sector development. It is rated on a six-point scale: highly successful, successful, mostly successful, mostly unsuccessful, unsuccessful, and highly unsuccessful.
- IFC additionality assesses both financial and nonfinancial additionality in terms of the benefit or value addition IFC brings that a client would not otherwise have. The rating is on a four-point scale: excellent, satisfactory, partly unsatisfactory, and unsatisfactory.
- IFC investment outcome assesses the extent to which IFC has realized at the time of the evaluation and expects to realize over the remaining life of the investment the loan income, equity returns, or both that were expected at approval. The rating is on a four-point scale: excellent, satisfactory, partly unsatisfactory, and unsatisfactory.
- IFC work quality assesses IFC's operational performance, including in relation to environmental and social aspects, with respect to precommitment work in screening, appraisal, and structuring, and its supervision and administration after project approval by the Board of Executive Directors and subsequent commitment. The rating is on a four-point scale: excellent, satisfactory, partly unsatisfactory, and unsatisfactory.

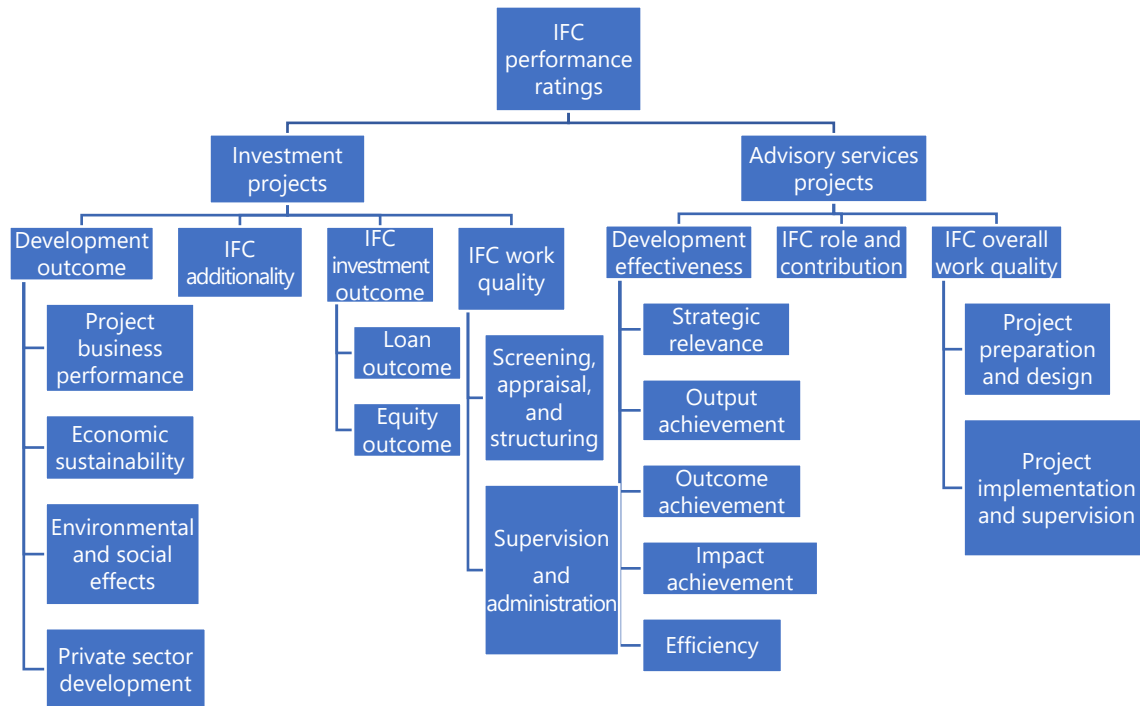
International Finance Corporation Advisory Services

The main source of evidence for analyzing the trends in IFC AS projects' performance ratings is the Project Completion Reports (PCRs)—IFC self-evaluations validated by IEG. For all client and sponsor development and market creation advisory projects, IFC AS operations staff conduct a self-evaluation at completion in the form of the PCR. IEG validates a random stratified representative sample of these reports (51 percent) each year through PCR Evaluative Notes. To conduct the project evaluation and validation, IFC and IEG staff refer to PCR guidelines that provide the evaluation framework and performance rating criteria. The performance ratings for IFC AS projects are derived from an objective-based methodology that establishes a minimum threshold for rating and assessing project effectiveness.

The main performance assessment dimensions for IFC AS projects are development effectiveness, IFC role and contribution, and IFC work quality (figure D.2). As part of development effectiveness performance, PCRs assess the sustainability of results over the long run and examine the project's impact achievement beyond the immediate and intermediate outcome achievements when observable:

- Development effectiveness synthesizes a project's performance across five indicators: strategic relevance, output achievement, outcome achievement, impact achievement, and efficiency. The rating is on a six-point scale: highly successful, successful, mostly successful, mostly unsuccessful, unsuccessful, and highly unsuccessful.
- IFC role and contribution assesses the extent to which IFC added value or made a special contribution to the AS project. The rating is on a four-point scale: excellent, satisfactory, partly unsatisfactory, and unsatisfactory.
- IFC work quality assesses the extent to which services provided ensured quality at entry and supported effective implementation, through appropriate supervision and execution, toward the achievement of development objectives. IFC work quality and its two dimensions—project preparation and design and project implementation and supervision—are rated on a four-point scale: excellent, satisfactory, partly unsatisfactory, and unsatisfactory.

**Figure D.2. Performance Ratings in International Finance Corporation
Investment Projects and Advisory Services Projects**



Source: Independent Evaluation Group.

Note: IFC = International Finance Corporation.

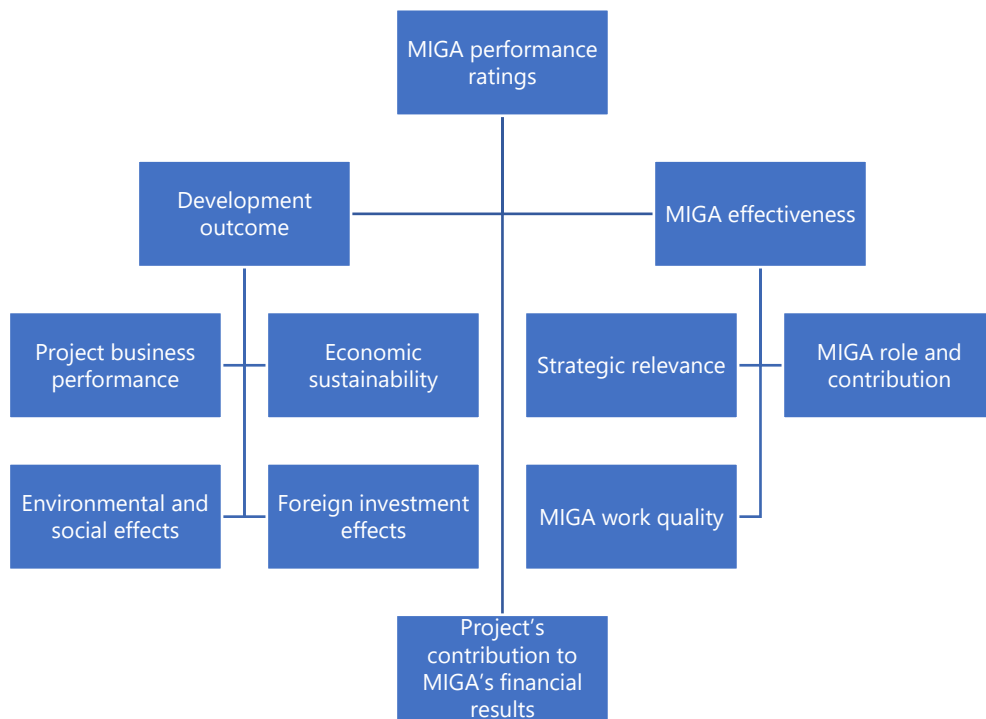
Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency Guarantees

The main source of evidence for analyzing the trends in MIGA guarantee projects' performance ratings is the Project Evaluation Reports (PERs) prepared by MIGA and validated by IEG. For each MIGA guarantee project that has reached early operating maturity, MIGA underwriting staff conduct a self-evaluation by preparing a PER that IEG independently validates through a PER Validation Note. To conduct the project evaluation and validation, both MIGA and IEG staff refer to PER guidelines that provide the evaluation framework and performance rating criteria. The evaluation system and performance rating system for MIGA projects are both objective and benchmark based. In addition to the focus on the achievement of expected objectives stated in the memorandum of the president's report at approval, the performance of MIGA guarantee projects is assessed against several comparators, such as performance of peer companies, the market, and similar industries, and considers unintended outcomes (both positive and negative).

The main performance assessment dimensions for MIGA guarantee projects are development outcome, MIGA role and contribution, and MIGA work quality (figure D.3). The PER also assesses the sustainability of development outcomes in the long run by examining the project's prospects over its remaining life.

- Development outcome measures performance across four indicators: project business performance, economic sustainability, environmental and social effects, and foreign investment effects. The development outcome is rated on a six-point scale: highly successful, successful, mostly successful, mostly unsuccessful, unsuccessful, and highly unsuccessful. Up to FY 2019, the ratings were based on a four-point scale: excellent, satisfactory, partly unsatisfactory, and unsatisfactory.
- MIGA effectiveness synthesizes MIGA's performance across three indicators: project strategic relevance, MIGA role and contribution, and MIGA work quality. The rating is on a four-point scale: excellent, satisfactory, partly unsatisfactory, and unsatisfactory.
- MIGA role and contribution assesses the benefits and value added that MIGA brings to the client, the project, or the political risk insurance industry. The rating is on a four-point scale: excellent, satisfactory, partly unsatisfactory, and unsatisfactory.
- MIGA work quality addresses due diligence and underwriting processes, including risk assessment and mitigation, and monitoring after the issuance of the MIGA guarantee. The rating is on a four-point scale: excellent, satisfactory, partly unsatisfactory, and unsatisfactory.

Figure D.3. Performance Ratings in Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency Guarantee Projects



Source: Independent Evaluation Group.

Note: MIGA = Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency.

Appendix E. Outcome Type Analysis for World Bank Group Projects

This appendix summarizes the outcome typology used in reviewing project objectives for the World Bank, International Finance Corporation (IFC) investment projects, and Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA) guarantee projects in *Results and Performance of the World Bank Group 2025 (RAP 2025)*.

World Bank

To track the outcomes being targeted in World Bank objectives over time, *RAP 2025* will employ the outcome typology developed for *RAP 2021* (World Bank 2021). This typology includes 16 different outcome types, derived from typical project theories of change and select corporate objectives. Table E.1 provides a list of these outcome types. The *RAP 2025* data set will incorporate outcome classifications from previous *RAPs* and new coding done for *RAP 2025*. Coding will be conducted at the objective level, with a maximum of three outcome types assigned per objective. *RAP 2025* will apply a retrieval-augmented generation approach, using embedding-based similarity to identify relevant text for each outcome type, followed by generative artificial intelligence to assist in validation. This process will be complemented by manual review to ensure accuracy and contextual understanding.

Table E.1. World Bank Project Outcome Typology

Outcome Type	Description
1. Access to services expanded	Opportunity of project beneficiaries to benefit from or use a system, service, or goods, including access to financial services, for example
2. Quality of services improved	Improving or upgrading service reliability, timeliness, affordability, cleanliness, frequency, and so on; improvement and maintenance
3. Public assets improved	Improving or enhancing the condition of built assets, which may include public spaces or public assets, and cultural heritage sites
4. Natural capital sustained	Improving or enhancing the condition of natural assets directly or indirectly, which may include air, water, biodiversity, and other aspects of the natural environment
5. Use of services of assets increased	Creating or enhancing incentives for people to use a good or service through adequate prices, regulation, incentives, and information about the existence of a service
6. Social safety net provided to individuals	Increased benefit to individuals through cash transfers or public work schemes
7. Awareness, attitudes, or behaviors changed	Increased awareness, enhanced attitudes, or enhanced behaviors on the part of project beneficiaries
8. Human capital increased	Increasing the knowledge or skills of individuals for their own benefit or improvements in, for example, health status
9. Individual employability or livelihood improved	Enhancing the employability of individuals and their ability to increase their earnings in the longer term, including fostering microenterprises or very small (family) business development (for example, support self-

Outcome Type	Description
	employed entrepreneurs to prepare business plans, provide small grant or loans, and enhance earnings not for consumption)
10. Citizen engagement, or community participation enhanced	Improved mechanisms that give regular people (or beneficiaries) a “say” or a “voice,” be it for intrinsic or instrumental value
11. Legal or regulatory context improved	Improving regulations, laws, codes, working conditions, standards, and environmental requirements
12. Capacity of institutions to perform institutional functions enhanced	Increasing the capacity of public and private institutions to better carry out their institutional function in the longer term
13. Accountability, transparency, or governance enhanced	Increasing transparency, accountability, and openness and combating corruption
14. Enterprise or sectoral performance improved	Improved productivity, efficiency, profitability, or competitiveness of a firm (including a state-owned enterprise) or private sector (nongovernment), understood as a group of firms
15. Productive sector expanded	Increasing the dimension and size of productive sector, for example, by supporting start-ups or higher investment in firms in both capital and employment
16. Equity or inclusion enhanced	Achieving greater inclusion and more equitable outcomes (for example, gender, ethnic minorities, poor people accessing services, and benefit) Improved targeting Equity: Special provision for increasing equity through active elements of the project (quotas, components designed explicitly for specific “disadvantaged” groups, and so on)

Source: Independent Evaluation Group.

International Finance Corporation Investments

RAP 2025 will continue to use the outcome typology developed in RAP 2021 to identify the outcomes being targeted in IFC investment projects. The typology has 33 (28 project-level and 5 market-level) outcomes based on 13 categories of outcome types (table E.2). The outcomes in the typology are aligned with those defined by IFC’s Anticipated Impact Measurement and Monitoring sector frameworks. *RAP 2025* will apply the outcome typology to all IFC investment projects self-evaluated by IFC and validated by the Independent Evaluation Group between calendar years 2022 and 2024 by a cutoff date of December 31, 2024.

Because the Anticipated Impact Measurement and Monitoring has assessed only a small share of projects evaluated in the calendar year 2022–24 cohort, *RAP 2025* will assess the extent to which expected outcomes were achieved at evaluation by verifying the results presented in the project Evaluative Note. An outcome is considered fully achieved, partially achieved, not achieved, or cannot be verified based solely on the text of the project Evaluative Note. The *RAP* team will not apply any additional judgment, assessment, or methodology.

Table E.2. Outcome Typology for International Finance Corporation Investment Projects

Outcome Type	Description
1.1—Access to goods and services	Increase in number of final beneficiaries of goods and services of the project or company; increase in volume of goods and services produced by project or company
1.1.1—Access to goods and services (MSMEs)	Increase in number of MSMEs as final beneficiaries of goods and services of the project or company; increase in volume of goods and services produced or provided by project or company
1.1.2—Access to goods and services (gender)	Increase in number of final female beneficiaries of goods and services of the project or company; increase in volume of goods and services produced or provided by project or company
1.1.3—Access to goods and services (customers)	Increase in number of individual customers as final beneficiaries of goods and services of the project or company; increase in volume of goods and services produced or provided by project or company
1.1.4—Access to goods and services (miscellaneous)	Increase in number of final beneficiaries of goods and services of the project or company other than MSMEs, female beneficiaries, and individual customers or a mix of these final beneficiaries; increase in volume of goods and services produced by project or company
1.1.5—Access to goods and services (direct client level)	Increase in capacity of project or direct client company to produce goods and services because of IFC investment
1.2—Quality and affordability of goods and services	Improved quality of goods and services produced by project or company compared with baseline or with other producers or providers; lower production costs or process; reduced prices of goods and services compared with the baseline or other producers or providers
1.2.1—Quality of goods and services	Improved quality of goods and services produced by project or company compared with the baseline or other producers or providers
1.2.2—Affordability of goods and services	Reduced prices of goods and services compared with the baseline or other producers or providers
1.2.3—Increased efficiency of direct client company	Lower production costs or processes of project or company
1.3—Increased capacity of final beneficiaries	Enhanced capacity of final beneficiaries as a result of advisory services or training that is part of project scope
1.4—Improved living standards (earnings) of individuals	Increase in revenue or decrease in expenditures by final beneficiaries (individuals) of goods and services produced by the project or company
1.5—Improved sales or profitability of enterprises	Increase in revenue, decrease in expenditures, or increase in overall productivity by final beneficiaries (enterprises) of goods and services produced by project or company
2.1—Suppliers and distributors reached	Increase in number of suppliers who provide inputs to project or company or expansion of network of distributors of goods or services produced by project or company
2.2—Improved capacity of suppliers and distributors	Increase in capacity of suppliers or distributors as a result of advisory services or training that is part of project scope
2.3—Improved sales and profitability of suppliers and distributors	Increase in volume of inputs provided by suppliers or increase in the goods or services to be distributed by its distributors
3.1—Increased employment	Increase in direct employment of client company
3.2—Improved capacity and skills	Training provided to employees of project or company
3.3—Improved earnings of employees	Increase in wages to employees of project or company

Outcome Type	Description
4.1—Increased transfers to government	Increase in payments by project or company to the government, such as in the form of taxes, royalties, fees, or dividends
5.1—Increased money spent or transferred to community	Increase in payments to communities in relation to the project or company, such as on health, educational, or vocational programs
6.1—Enhanced environmental and social standards of the client	Improvement in IFC's Performance Standards on Environmental and Social Sustainability
6.2—Greenhouse gas emissions	Decrease in or avoidance of greenhouse gas emissions
6.3—Efficient use of resources	Decrease in use of water and other resources, improvement in solid waste management, and implementation of a waste-to-energy project
7.1—Gross value added	Gross value added to economy (calculated based on a multiplier and expressed in monetary value)
7.2—Induced and indirect employment	Induced and indirect employment based on multipliers
7.3—Exports	Increase in exports of goods and services, generating foreign currency
8.1—Governance	Improvement in corporate governance or increase in capacity of client company
9—Competition in the market	Increase in ability of firms to enter, exit, compete, innovate, and strive for efficiency under fair and good regulatory governance; price changes; new practices, technology, and product innovation (first movers); product and business model differentiation, change in product offering, and value addition; and increase in efficiency under fair and good regulatory governance
10—Resilience in the market	Increase in market depth and improvement in market structure, regulation, and governance to help markets withstand physical, financial, economic, or climate-related shocks; improved corporate governance of direct clients; diversification (for example, energy sources or funding sources in sectors or products); increase in capacity to face shocks and stress; increase in market depth and improvement in market structure, regulation, and governance (capacity of regulator); decrease in domestic supply volatility; increase in energy security; and increase in financial stability and consumer protection
11—Integration in the market	Increase in physical or financial connectivity to support greater market integration, greater integration with financial markets and domestic and global value chains, enhanced physical or financial connectivity, geographical integration, integration with financial markets (including capital mobilization), data integration, growing domestic and global value chains, trade diversification, and economic complexity
12—Inclusiveness in the market	Increase in fair and full access to all goods, services, finance, and economic opportunities, including for underserved groups; increased inclusiveness and improved access; establishment of marketwide enabling framework or standards supporting inclusive business; and increase in diversity
13—Sustainability in the market	Adoption of climate-related, environmentally and socially sustainable products, technologies, and practices; increased ability of firms and industries to apply environmentally and socially sustainable approaches to mitigate risk, realize opportunities, and maximize operational efficiency; adoption of climate-related, environmentally and socially sustainable products, technologies, standards, and practices; development of legal or regulatory framework that fosters sustainability; and broad capacity and supporting institutions or sustainability practice

Source: Independent Evaluation Group.

Note: IFC = International Finance Corporation; MSMEs = micro, small, and medium enterprises.

Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency Guarantees

RAP 2025 will continue to use the outcome typology developed in RAP 2021 and enhanced by RAP 2023 to identify the outcomes being targeted in MIGA guarantee projects. The typology has 30 (25 project-level and 5 market-level) outcomes. Because sector-specific frameworks do not yet exist for MIGA's Impact Measurement and Project Assessment Comparison Tool, the same outcome typology developed for IFC investment projects will be applied to MIGA guarantee projects, with adaptations to some outcome types (table E.3). *RAP 2025* will apply the outcome typology to all MIGA guarantee projects self-evaluated by MIGA and validated by the Independent Evaluation Group between FY 2022 and FY24 by a cutoff date of March 31, 2025.

Because no Impact Measurement and Project Assessment Comparison Tool assessments are available in the FY22–24 cohort, *RAP 2025* will assess the extent to which expected outcomes were achieved at evaluation by verifying the results presented in the project Validation Notes. An outcome is considered fully achieved, partially achieved, not achieved, or cannot be verified based solely on the text of the project Validation Notes. The *RAP* team will not apply any additional judgment, assessment, or methodology. The achievement of outcomes will be based solely on evidence from the Independent Evaluation Group's Validation Notes. It should be noted that only a small number of projects were evaluated and validated since the previous *RAP*.

Table E.3. Outcome Typology for Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency Projects

Outcome Type	Description
1.1—Access to goods and services	Increased number of final beneficiaries of goods and services of the project or company; increased volume of goods and services produced by the project or company can be considered under this outcome type
1.1.1—Access to goods and services (MSMEs)	Increased number of MSMEs as final beneficiaries of goods and services of the project or company; increased volume of goods and services produced or provided by the project or company
1.1.2—Access to goods and services (female)	Increased number of final female beneficiaries of goods and services of the project or company
1.1.3—Access to goods and services (customers)	Increased number of individual customers as final beneficiaries of goods and services of the project or company; customers of utility services are representative of this group; increased volume of goods and services produced or provided by the project or company
1.1.4—Access to goods and services (miscellaneous)	Increased number of individual customers as final beneficiaries of goods and services of the project or company; customers of utility services are representative of this group; increased volume of goods and services produced or provided by the project or company
1.2—Quality and affordability of goods and services	Improved quality of goods and services produced by the project or company, compared with the baseline or with other producers or providers; lower production costs and process are covered by affordability; reduced prices of goods and services compared with the baseline or with other produces or providers

Outcome Type	Description
1.3—Enhanced capacity of final beneficiaries	Enhanced capacity of the final beneficiaries as a result of advisory services or training that is part of the project scope
1.4—Improved living standards (earnings) of individuals	Increased revenue or reduced expenditure by the final beneficiaries (individuals) of goods and services produced by the project or company
1.5—Improved sales and profitability of enterprises	Increased revenue, reduced expenditure, or increased overall productivity by the final beneficiaries (enterprises) of goods and services produced by the project or company
1.6—Economic return	Economic rate of return
1.7—Financial and business performance of direct clients	Financial and business performance of direct clients, mostly project-executing agencies
2.1—Suppliers and distributors reached	Increased number of suppliers who provide inputs to the project or company, or the project expands the network of distributors of goods or services produced by the project or company
2.2—Improved capacity of suppliers and distributors	Capacity of suppliers or distributors improved as a result of advisory services or training that is part of the project scope
2.3—Improved sales and profitability of suppliers and distributors	The project increases the volume of inputs provided by its suppliers, or the project increases the goods or services to be distributed by its distributors
3.1—Increased employment	Increased direct employment of the client company
3.2—Improved capacity and skills	Training is provided to the employees of the project or company
3.3—Improved earning of employees	Increased wages to employees of the project or company
4.1—Increased transfers to the government	Payment from the projects or companies to the governments, such as tax, royalties, fees, and dividend
5.1—Increased money spent and transferred to the communities	Payment to the communities around the project or company, such as health, educational, and vocational programs in association with infrastructure projects
6.1—Enhanced E&S standards of the client	MIGA supports its clients to enhance their E&S standards
6.2—Greenhouse gas reduction	Projects such as renewable energy projects and energy efficiency projects that contribute to the reduction or avoidance of greenhouse gases
6.3—Efficient use of resources	The project will reduce use of water and other resources, or the project will promote solid waste management and implement a waste-to-energy project
7.1—Gross value added	The project brings gross value added to the economy, which is calculated based on a multiplier and expressed in monetary value
7.2—Induced or indirect employment	Induced and indirect employment as a result of the project; this is also based on the multipliers
7.3—Export sales	The project increases exports of goods and services produced; the economy's external balance from the generation and consumption of foreign currency
8.1—Governance	Enhanced governance or capacity of MIGA's client company
9—Business and sector practices	Potential to improve (financial or operational) performance of future investments through demonstration or transfer of new technologies, capabilities, practices, or business models

Outcome Type	Description
10—Market development	Potential to enhance the market structure through increased competitiveness, resilience, integration, enhancements to the regulatory environment, and so on
11—Development reach	Potential to stimulate future investments that increase inclusion and reduce inequality by reaching underserved populations (BoP, women, youth, and so on)
12—Sustainability	Potential to stimulate future investments to focus on climate change adaptation and mitigation, and adopting improved E&S standards and practices
13—Signaling effects	Potential to stimulate further foreign investment in contexts where there are real or perceived barriers for domestic and foreign investors and lenders

Source: Independent Evaluation Group.

Note: BoP = base of the pyramid; E&S = environmental and social; MIGA = Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency; MSMEs = micro, small, and medium enterprises.

Reference

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Appendix F. Factors Linked to Performance of International Finance Corporation and Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency Projects

International Finance Corporation Investments

To identify the factors influencing International Finance Corporation (IFC) investment project implementation and performance, *Results and Performance of the World Bank Group 2025 (RAP 2025)* will conduct a desk-based review and content analysis of project evaluation and validation documents. This includes IFC investment projects evaluated and validated by the Independent Evaluation Group (IEG) between calendar years 2022 and 2024 by a cutoff date of December 31, 2024. For each project, the *RAP* team will identify the top three factors that positively or negatively affected project performance and will classify them using the taxonomy of performance factors, consisting of five categories and 51 subcategories developed by the IEG Private Sector/Finance Evaluation Unit (table F.1). The taxonomy is based on common challenges and issues faced in more than 1,000 evaluated IFC investment projects. For these projects, IEG had used machine learning in addition to IEG evaluators to identify key performance factors and classify categories and subcategories.

Table F.1. Taxonomy of Performance Factors for International Finance Corporation Investment Projects

No.	Category	Subcategory	Definition
1	Country and macro factors	Civil unrest and armed conflict	Factors related to civil unrest, armed conflict, and war
2		Economic factors	Factors related to the macroeconomic environment, inflation, monetary policy, or austerity measures
3		Epidemics and COVID-19	Factors related to epidemics (human, animal, and plant) and COVID-19
4		Expropriation, nationalization, and transferability	Factors related to expropriation, nationalization, transfer, and convertibility
5		Foreign exchange and local currency factors	Factors related to currency fluctuation, exchange rate, and local currency issuance instruments
6		Legal or regulatory factors	Factors related to regulatory policies, government, legislation, and bureaucratic mechanisms
7		Natural disasters	Factors related to natural disasters, such as hurricanes and earthquakes
8		Political factors	Factors related to the political environment, including legislative and electoral dynamics
9		Business factors	Factors related to business model, cyclical business, or the operating environment

No.	Category	Subcategory	Definition
10	Market, sector, and industry factors	Competition	Factors related to market competition, including barriers to entry, monopolies, market dominance, and penetration
11		Customers	Factors related to identifying correct target markets and clientele
12		Market share	Factors related to market share
13		Pricing	Factors related to price elasticity, supply, and marginal gains
14	Sponsor or client (management, sponsorship, and leadership)	Capacity, capitalization, and leverage	Factors related to sponsor capacity, capitalization, and leverage
15		Commitment and motivation	Factors related to the strength and valence of strategic alignment, including issues of compatibility, motivation, and ownership
16		Conflicts of interest and corporate governance	Factors related to minority interest, conflicts of interest, and corporate governance
17		Integrity, transparency, fairness, and reputation	Factors related to integrity and transparency, such as disclosures of sensitive ethical issues, irregularities, and negative public perceptions
18		Organizational structure	Factors related to organizational culture, institutional procedures, policies, and accountability
19		Technical expertise, track record, and capacity	Factors related to the quality and expertise of the management team, their technical skills and track record, and contractor competency, familiarity, and acumen
20		Succession	Factors related to succession, especially in family-owned businesses
21		Asset quality	Factors related to asset quality
22	Project-inherent challenges	Cost overruns and delays	Factors related to overruns or delays
23		Earnings and profitability	Factors related to earnings and profitability
24		Environment and sustainability	Factors related to environmental standards, social health and safety parameters, or other safety standards
25		Expansion	Factors related to acquisition, modernization, and expansion
26		Funding	Factors related to funding
27		Greenfield	Factors related to greenfield projects
28		Gender	Factors related to gender
29		Liquidity	Factors related to liquidity
30		Technology	Factors related to changes in technology that affect project performance
31		Training, know-how, and implementation	Factors related to training and know-how
32	Other	Additionality principle and catalytic role	Factors related to additionality and added value

No.	Category	Subcategory	Definition
33		Coordination and collaboration with the World Bank, other DFIs, donors, and other external stakeholders	Factors related to combined partnership and collaboration among the various stakeholders: the World Bank, donors, DFIs, and other external stakeholders
34		Coordination and collaboration within IFC: investment and advisory services	Factors related to use of investment and advisory services to enhance IFC roles and contributions
35		Project scoping and screening, country and stakeholder assessment, and client needs assessment	Factors related to ex ante market analysis, due diligence, and consumer preferences
36		Client selection, commitment, and capacity	Factors related to client or implementing partner selection (appropriateness) and client commitment and involvement
37		Project design	Factors related to project design
38		Financial model, project cost, and sensitivity assumptions	Factors related to financial modeling assumptions, including issues regarding overambitious objectives, deviations from forecasting estimates, and scaling
39		Market assessment	Factors related to market assessment, market analysis, and consumer preferences
40		Resources and timeline	Factors related to staffing, budget, and timeline
41		Supervision and reporting	Factors related to supervision and reporting and taking measures to enhance these and proactive client and stakeholder follow-up
42		Sensitivity analysis	Factors related to sensitivity analysis, worst-case scenarios, stress tests, and risks to achieving development outcomes
43		Documentation	Factors related to the quality of monitoring, documentation, and reporting
44		Loan issues	Factors related to loan agreements, operating policies, breaches, or technical defaults
45		Relationship management	Factors related to the quality and scope of relationship management, including fruitful and proactive engagements with on-site staff
46		Debt issues	Factors related to debt issues, such as syndication, repayment, security, and refinancing
47		Equity issues	Factors related to equity, valuation, and shareholder rights
48		Financial risk mitigation	Factors related to risk mitigation mechanisms, such as guarantees, securities, prepayment penalties, and restructuring mechanisms
49		Prepayments	Factors related to prepayments

No.	Category	Subcategory	Definition
50		Monitoring and evaluation	Factors related to compliance and monitoring, including measurement, reporting, auditing, monitoring and evaluation plan and framework, appropriate indicators and targets, and clarity of data collection and evaluation approach
51		Other issues	Factors related to other issues

Source: Independent Evaluation Group.

Note: DFI = development finance institution; IFC = International Finance Corporation.

Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency Guarantees

To identify the factors influencing Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency guarantee project implementation and performance, *RAP 2025* will conduct a desk-based review and content analysis of project evaluation and validation documents. This includes Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency guarantee projects self-evaluated by the Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency and validated by IEG between FY 2022 and FY24 by a cutoff date of December 31, 2024. For each project, the *RAP* team will identify the top three factors that positively or negatively affected project performance and will classify them using the same taxonomy of performance factors used for IFC investment (refer to table F.1).

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Appendix G. Results and Performance of the World Bank Group 2025

Design Matrix

Information Required	Information Sample and Sources	Data Collection Methods and Data Analysis	Strengths and Limitations
<i>RAP</i> question 1: How have IEG country and project ratings changed over time and across countries and projects?			
Component 1: Trends in IEG ratings of World Bank Group projects	World Bank lending projects closed from FY14 to FY24 and validated by IEG by the end of FY25.	Data extracted from World Bank Data Explorer, IEG Data Hub, and private sector project portfolio and evaluation databases.	Since a strategy for harmonizing the project-level performance ratings of the World Bank, IFC, and MIGA into One World Bank Group is not yet in place, <i>RAP 2025</i> will report the performance ratings across the three Bank Group institutions individually. Harmonization of the ratings for the three Bank Group institutions is a separate exercise (not part of <i>RAP 2025</i>) and would involve extensive consultations with the Bank Group counterparts.
Interactive dashboard (World Bank only)	- IEG Data Hub performance ratings for the World Bank. - World Bank Data Explorer databases on project and country characteristics. - IFC project performance ratings for IFC investment projects in CY14–24 evaluated and validated by IEG as of June 30, 2025. - IFC project performance ratings for IFC AS projects in FY14–24 evaluated and validated by IEG as of June 30, 2025. - MIGA project performance ratings for MIGA guarantee projects in FY14–24 evaluated and validated by IEG as of June 30, 2025. - IFC databases on project characteristics (for example, management information system for investment projects and AS database). - MIGA contract issuance database on project characteristics for guarantee.	- Descriptive statistics of trends in ratings, including breakdowns for project ratings analysis, include the following: FCS exposure, country lending group, lending instrument, project size, Global Practices, Region, and outcome types. - Statistical analysis of ratings at operational levels, including correlation, statistical significance in difference. - Decomposition analysis seeks to distinguish between shifts within subgroups and changes in portfolio composition. - For IFC investment projects and AS projects and MIGA guarantee projects, descriptive statistics will involve breakdown of project performance ratings across various subgroups such as Regions, FCS, country lending group (IDA and blend), investment instrument type (loan and equity), investment size, industry group (for IFC investments) or primary business area (for IFC AS), and sector (for MIGA).	- The use of standardized ratings and well-tested methods allows for consistent replication and longitudinal trend analysis. - Because the ratings are aggregated and encompass a wide variety of project types, locations, and contexts, they may obscure underlying mechanisms or contextual factors that drive results, making direct comparisons among time periods more challenging. - Some recently closed projects are evaluated relatively quickly after closure, whereas others experience delays and remain unrated by IEG, potentially biasing trends

Information Required	Information Sample and Sources	Data Collection Methods and Data Analysis	Strengths and Limitations
		- For IFC investment projects, analysis of performance ratings of work quality, additionality, and investment outcome and their association with project development outcomes. - For IFC AS projects, analysis of performance ratings of work quality and role and contribution and their association with project development effectiveness.	- for more recent fiscal years. - MIGA is behind on submitting self-evaluations of its guarantee projects, which prevents IEG from having an accurate picture of its overall development outcome ratings. The pending self-evaluations from MIGA mean that it is difficult to comment too definitively on trends in development outcome ratings.
Component 2: Outcome types of the Bank Group objectives	World Bank IPF projects closed during FY17–24 and validated by IEG as of June 30, 2025.	Coding of World Bank projects' individual objectives based on <i>RAP 2023</i> outcome typology (see appendix E). The coding will combine deep learning large language models with manual review by expert evaluators to enhance consistency and efficiency.	The outcome typology classifies project objectives across sectors and types, offering a clearer view of performance against intended changes in PDOs.
Description of patterns of intended types of outcomes defined in PDOs	- Data of project objectives from IEG Data Hub. - IFC investment projects evaluated and validated by IEG in CY22–24 with a cutoff date of December 31, 2024.	Analysis of distribution of outcome types over time and across various subgroups, examining how different outcome types correlated with project ratings in different contexts.	Continued analysis of typologies enables trend tracking over time.
Classification of projects' individual objectives based on <i>RAP 2021</i> outcome typology	- AIMM data on outcome indicators for IFC investment projects in CY22–24 evaluated and validated by IEG with a cutoff date of February 28, 2025. - PERs of MIGA guarantee project in FY22–24 evaluated and validated by IEG with a cutoff date of March 31, 2025. - Data sets on outcome type analysis for IFC investment and MIGA guarantee projects from <i>RAP 2024</i>.	Similar data collection and analysis methods for IFC investment and MIGA guarantee projects, except that the extent of achievement of specific development outcomes will be established through a desk-based review and descriptive statistics to explore links between the intended outcome types and their achievement rates.	- Assessing objectives at the individual level reveals outcome patterns that might otherwise remain hidden at the project level. - Not all intended outcomes appear in the PDO, limiting the typology's explanatory power. - The challenge is greater for outcome types with few observations, making conclusions difficult. - IEG project-level evaluation and validation documents do not rate intended outcomes pursued by IFC investment and MIGA guarantee projects. The

Information Required	Information Sample and Sources	Data Collection Methods and Data Analysis	Strengths and Limitations
		For IFC investment projects, analysis to assess whether the AIMM system, which is IFC's ex ante analysis and monitoring tool for development outcome, is enhancing the identification and tracking of outcomes. The report will analyze the complete universe of 62 evaluated IFC investments with "live" AIMM scores (projects that IFC assigned ex ante AIMM scores at Board approval). This is the complete universe of projects evaluated by IEG with live AIMM scores as of February 28, 2025.	objectives of IFC investment and MIGA guarantee projects are assessed but not rated because IEG validations of the Expanded Project Supervision Reports are both objective based and benchmark based (based on market and industry standards), which considers long-term sustainability effects and trends rather than focusing solely on the achievement of intended objective.
Component 3: Factors linked to performance of IFC and MIGA projects The objective is to describe trends in factors linked to projects' performance	- IFC investment projects in CY22–24 evaluated and validated by IEG as of December 31, 2024. - MIGA guarantee projects in FY22–24 evaluated and validated by IEG as of December 31, 2024. - Project Insights taxonomy of performance factors consisting of five categories and 51 subcategories developed by the IEG Private Sector/Finance Evaluation Unit. The taxonomy is based on common challenges and issues faced in more than 1,000 evaluated IFC investment projects.	For IFC investment and MIGA guarantee projects, a desk-based review and content analysis to classify top three factors of performance, leveraging the Project Insights taxonomy developed by the IEG Private Sector/Finance Evaluation Unit.	The taxonomy of performance factors for IFC investment projects developed by the IEG Private Sector/Finance Evaluation Unit may require some adjustments because it has been fully tested for IFC investment projects in three industry groups (FIG, Disruptive Technologies and Funds, and Infrastructure and Natural Resources) and has been partially tested for projects in the Manufacturing, Agribusiness, and Services industry group.
Component 4: Factors specific to IFC work quality and IFC additionality that are associated with development outcome ratings of IFC investment projects	IFC investment projects in CY22–24 evaluated and validated by IEG as of December 31, 2024.	This analysis will include IFC investment projects evaluated and validated by IEG in CY22–24 that are on both ends of the ratings spectrum for work quality and development	Causality among IFC work quality, IFC additionality, and IFC's development outcome ratings may not be possible because both positive and negative factors beyond IFC's work

Information Required	Information Sample and Sources	Data Collection Methods and Data Analysis	Strengths and Limitations
		outcomes. The positive end of the spectrum indicates projects with development outcomes rated highly successful or successful and work quality rated excellent or satisfactory (30 projects). Similarly, the negative end of the spectrum indicates projects with development outcomes rated highly unsuccessful or unsuccessful and work quality rated unsatisfactory or partly unsatisfactory (41 projects). Factors linked to work quality will be identified through a desk-based review and content analysis of IEG project evaluation and validation documents. • A similar desk-based review of IFC investment projects evaluated and validated by IEG in CY22–24 (that are on both ends of the ratings spectrum for additionality and development outcomes—29 projects at the positive end of the spectrum and 36 projects at the negative end of the spectrum) will be conducted to analyze (i) frequency of occurrences of financial and nonfinancial additionality anticipated at Board approval, (ii) additionality realized (fully or partially) or unrealized, and (iii) frequency of occurrences of unanticipated additionality (only those not anticipated in the Board paper but materialized).	quality and additionality can contribute to the development outcome ratings of IFC investment projects.

Information Required	Information Sample and Sources	Data Collection Methods and Data Analysis	Strengths and Limitations
Component 5: Synthesizing lessons on strategic areas in MIGA with weak performance	MIGA guarantee projects in FY19–24 evaluated and validated by IEG as of March 31, 2025.	A desk-based review of MIGA guarantee projects evaluated and validated by IEG in FY19–24 to synthesize lessons on the following strategic areas for MIGA: IDA and Sub-Saharan Africa.	This deep dive will help the Board, MIGA management, and MIGA operation teams to understand lessons on what worked and did not work in strategic areas with weak performance ratings.
Component 6: Trends in Bank Group country program ratings	- Bank Group CLRVs that include CPF coverage during FY14–24 and finalized by IEG as of June 2025. - World Bank Data Explorer databases on country characteristics.	- Descriptive statistics of performance trends across periods for country correlation analysis using defined breakdowns (analysis will also be undertaken using breakdowns such as FCS, non-FCS, country lending group, and small states). - Identify countries always rated good and above, always rated fair and below, those that shift from good to fair, and those that shift from fair to good.	Analysis in <i>RAP 2025</i> provides previous findings to build on.
<i>RAP</i> question 2: How have World Bank ASA and IFC AS contributed to and influenced public and private sector client outcomes?			
<i>RAP</i> question 2a: How have World Bank ASA been used to contribute to development outcomes, and how has this use been monitored? How can the use and influence of ASA and its monitoring be enhanced in the future?			
Components 7–9: Types of use of ASA and pathways of use	IEG sources:		
- Monitoring of the use of ASA - World Bank inputs, action, and performance related to ASA - Ways to enhance the use of ASA and its monitoring	22 completed CPEs (excluding 2 clustered CPEs for small states and resource-rich countries) for the period FY10–25 (up to March 2025). 21 completed CLRVs (or CASCs) for the period FY10–25 (up to March 2025) sampled purposively for this <i>RAP</i>. 22 corporate, sector, and thematic evaluations.	The illustrative questionnaire will be applied to IEG and World Bank sources to analyze ASA use and influence (appendix B). The use of AI-assisted text analytics will be explored.	This analysis can help strengthen the World Bank's use and monitoring of ASA and support the World Bank's aspiration of a Knowledge Bank. A limitation is that IEG evaluations do not all address ASA with the same depth or methods. For example, ASA design documents do not always clearly specify the objectives or anticipated outcomes, and Activity Completion Summaries for ASA may not include

Information Required	Information Sample and Sources	Data Collection Methods and Data Analysis	Strengths and Limitations
	World Bank sources: • CLRs and country-specific ASA population launched during FY17–24 and closed as of June 24, 2025.		evidence on ASA use or influence. The use of ASA in contributing to development outcomes may also not be linear and may occur with a lag.
RAP question 2b: What does the evidence show in terms of IFC AS contributions to both governments (enabling environment advisory) and private sector clients (firm-level advisory)?			
Component 10: Analyzing contributions of IFC AS to policy reforms (enabling environment advisory)	• IEG evaluations and validations in FY22–24 of 61 IFC AS projects that have objectives focusing on regulations.	• IEG will conduct a desk-based review of IFC AS projects evaluated and validated by IEG between FY22 and FY24 that have objectives focusing on regulations. The purpose of this analysis is to understand the extent to which IFC AS is contributing to policy reforms. As part of this analysis, IEG will identify some of the key policy reforms targeted by IFC AS projects and the status of these reforms (drafting, adoption, and implementation). In addition, IEG will synthesize lessons on what worked and what did not work on IFC AS contributions to policy reforms.	
Component 11: Analyzing factors linked to performance of IFC AS (primarily firm-level advisory)	• IEG evaluations and validations in FY22–24 of 36 IFC AS projects in FIG.	• IEG will conduct a desk-based review to code factors linked to IFC AS performance only for FIG projects evaluated and validated by IEG in FY22–24. For each project, IEG will manually identify up to three factors that are positively or negatively linked to project performance and classify them using a pilot taxonomy of performance factors that will be developed by IEG Private Sector/Finance Evaluation	• Given the limited time and budget, FIG was chosen as a starting point for IFC AS analysis of factors linked to performance because it is the largest sector in IFC, is fairly homogenous, and will help IEG to set the stage for the coding of IFC AS projects in other sectors in the future.

Information Required	Information Sample and Sources	Data Collection Methods and Data Analysis	Strengths and Limitations
Component 12: Distilling lessons on linkages between IFC AS and IFC investments (primarily firm-level advisory)	• IEG evaluations and validations of 113 linked IFC investment and IFC AS projects in 2019–24. Of these 113 linked projects, 31 projects have IEG evaluations and validations for both IFC investment and IFC AS projects, 23 projects have IEG evaluations and validations only for IFC investment projects but not for IFC AS projects, and 59 have IEG evaluations and validations only for IFC AS projects but not for IFC investment projects.	Unit. IEG will synthesize lessons on what worked and what did not work for the top three factors linked to IFC AS performance. • For the purposes of <i>RAP 2025</i>, IEG will analyze the 31 linked projects with IEG evaluations and validations for both IFC investment and IFC AS projects in 2019–24 (that is, IEG validations of IFC self-evaluations or independent evaluations of investment projects that reached maturity in CY19–24 and IEG validations of self-evaluations of AS projects delivered by IFC in FY19–24). Based on a desk-based review of these 31 linked projects, IEG will synthesize lessons on what worked and what did not work on (i) how IFC AS contributed to investment outcomes and (ii) the extent of collaboration between IFC AS and investment teams.	• In the case of linked IFC investment and IFC AS projects, there will be situations where there are IEG evaluations and validations for IFC investment projects but not for IFC AS projects and vice versa. For the purposes of lessons on what worked and what did not work, IEG will conduct a desk-based review of all linked projects with IEG evaluations and validations for both IFC investment and IFC AS projects in 2019–24 (31 projects).

Source: Independent Evaluation Group.

Note: AIMM = Anticipated Impact Measurement and Monitoring; AS = advisory services; ASA = advisory services and analytics; CASCR = Country Assistance Strategy Completion Report; CLR = Completion and Learning Review; CLRV = Completion and Learning Review Validation; CPE = Country Program Evaluation; CPF = Country Partnership Framework; CY = calendar year; FCS = fragile and conflict-affected situations; FIG = Financial Institutions Group; IDA = International Development Association; IEG = Independent Evaluation Group; IFC = International Finance Corporation; IPF = investment project financing; MIGA = Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency; PDO = project development objective; PER = Project Evaluation Report; *RAP* = *Results and Performance of the World Bank Group*.

Bibliography

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Appendix H. Evaluation Team and Skills Mix

The task team leaders are Soniya Carvalho and Melvin P. Vaz. The core team members for the World Bank are Tanzima Chowdhury, Janet Entwistle, Lev Freinkman, Breda Griffith, Morgan Holmes, Giuseppe Iarossi, Naoko Kojo, Hoveida Nobakht, and Xiaoxiao Peng. Core team members for the International Finance Corporation and the Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency are Stephen Miller, Daniel Palazov, Konstantin Panov, Rama Seth, Ichiro Toda, and Stefan Triendl. In addition, the following Independent Evaluation Group units or groups will provide inputs and guidance: the Private Sector/Finance Evaluation Unit, the Methods Group, and the Economic Management and Country Program Unit.